

□ Complete Art & Culture — Study Notes

□ Session Scope

- **Period covered:** Indus Valley Civilization → Modern Architecture
- **Domains covered:**
 - Architecture (Ancient → Modern)
 - Painting
 - Music (Classical & Folk)
 - Classical & Folk Dance forms
- **Miscellaneous topics included:**
 - Fairs & Festivals
 - Handicrafts
 - Martial Arts
 - Languages
 - Different Schools of Philosophy
 - Bhakti & Sufi Movements

□ Objective

- Single comprehensive video covering the **entire Art & Culture** portion of the UPSC GS syllabus.
- Structured as a journey through India's art and cultural heritage.

Indus Valley Civilisation — Art, Architecture & Sculpture

Having laid out the scope of this journey, we begin at the very foundation of Indian culture — the Indus Valley Civilisation, where scientific town planning and exquisite craftsmanship first emerged.

Chronological Framework

- **Indian cultural history begins ~3200 BC** → Indus Valley Civilisation (IVC)
- **IVC ended ~1500 BC** → followed by **Vedic Period** (no evidence of well-planned cities)

- **Vedic → Mauryan & Post-Mauryan → Hindu Temple Architecture → Medieval → Modern**
- IVC discovered in **1920 by Charles Masson**
- One of 4 great ancient urban civilisations (others: Egypt, Mesopotamia, China)
- Also called **Harappan Civilisation** (emerged ~2500 BC on Indus River banks)
- Spanned large parts of **North-Western & Western India**

Architecture — Town Planning

Feature	Detail
Layout	Rectangular grid pattern
Roads	North-South & East-West, intersecting at right angles
Main roads	Divided city into blocks
Lanes	Smaller lanes connected individual homes to main roads
Building types (3)	Dwelling houses, Public buildings, Public baths

Construction Material

- **Burnt mud bricks** with **standardised dimensions**
- Multi-layered bricks joined with **gypsum mortar**

City Division

Zone	Location	Contents
Upper Citadel	Western part	Granaries, Administrative buildings, Pillared halls, Courtyards
Lower City	Eastern part	One-room houses (working class quarters), some double-story (stairs found)

Granaries

- Designed with **strategic air ducts & raised platforms**
- Purpose: store grain, **protect from pests**

Great Bath (Mohenjo-daro)

- Most famous public bath
- Surrounded by galleries & rooms
- **No cracks or leaks** → demonstrates advanced engineering
- Indicates **ritualistic cleansing** importance in culture

Housing Features (Lower City)

- Private wells, bathrooms, proper ventilation
- Double-story houses in some cases

Drainage System — Most Striking Feature

- Small drains from every house → connected to larger drains
- Large drains ran **along main roads**
- **Loose covers** for regular cleaning & maintenance
- **Cesspits at regular intervals** for sewage collection
- Demonstrates exceptional personal & public hygiene priority

Sculptures

- Highly proficient in **3D volumes**
- Most common finds: **Seals, Bronze figures, Pottery**

1. Seals

Aspect	Detail
Shapes	Mostly square; also triangular, rectangular, circular
Primary material	Steatite (soft stone) — most common
Other materials	Agate, copper, faience, terracotta; some gold, ivory, copper
Script	Pictographic script — still undeciphered
Animal engravings	5 common animals: Unicorn, Hump bull, Rhinoceros, Tiger, Elephant, Buffalo, Bison, Goat, Ibex, Crocodile
Missing animal	NO evidence of cow on any seal
Imaginary creatures	Half-man half-animal figures
Symbols	Swastik-like designs found

Uses of Seals: - Primary: **Commercial purposes** & communication - **Trade:** found in Mesopotamia & Lothal → extensive trade use - **Amulets/Talisman:** found on dead bodies with holes - **Education:** some had mathematical images - **Famous examples:** **Pashupati Seal** (Mohenjo-daro), **Unicorn Seal**

2. Bronze Figures — Lost Wax Technique (Cire Perdue)

Process: 1. Wax figure created → coated with wet clay 2. Dried → heated → wax melts out through small hole 3. Liquid metal poured into cavity 4. Cooled → clay removed → metal statue matches original wax shape

Still used today in many parts of India.

Dancing Girl (Mohenjo-daro)

- **World's oldest bronze sculpture**
- **4 inches** tall
- Left arm: bangles | Right arm: amulet & bracelet
- **Tribhanga** dancing posture
- Bronze casting was widely practiced

3. Terracotta Figures

- **Fire-baked clay**
- Fewer in number than bronze figures
- Made by **pinching method**
- Mainly found in: **Gujarat & Kalibangan**

Pottery

Type	Description
Plain pottery	Household use — grain & water storage
Painted pottery	Red & Black pottery: red background, black designs on top Themes: Trees, birds, animal figures, geometric patterns
Miniature vessels	Decoration — excellent craft quality
Perforated pottery	Possibly for liquor making

- Mostly **fine wheel-made wares**; few hand-made

Ornaments & Fashion

- Materials: **Precious metals, gemstones, bones, baked clay**
- **Both men and women** wore ornaments
- Common: Necklaces, fillets, armlets, finger rings, girdles
- **Only women:** Earrings, anklets
- **Popular beads:** Cornelian, amethyst, quartz, steatite
- **Large-scale bead production:** Factories at **Chanho-daro & Lothal**
- **Fabric:** Cotton & wool (worn by rich and poor)
- **Fashion-conscious:** diverse hairstyles & beards

Stone Sculpture Example

Bearded Priest (Mohenjo-daro)

- Famous bust — excellent stone figure example
- Wrapped in shawl with **trefoil pattern**

- **Elongated eyes**

Important Sites & Key Archaeological Findings

Site	Location (Present)	River	Key Findings
Harappa	Pakistan	Ravi	6 granaries (2 rows), Lingam & Yoni symbols, Mother Goddess figure, wheat & barley (wooden mortar), dice, copper scale, mirror, bronze sculpture (dog chasing deer), Red sandstone male torso
Mohenjo-daro	Pakistan	Indus	Citadel, Great Bath, Great Granary , post-cremation burial, Bearded Priest, Dancing Girl, Pashupati Seal
Dholavira	Gujarat	—	Giant water reservoir, unique water harnessing system, stadium, dams, embankments, 10 large inscriptions , rice husk, fire altars, painted chess-like game, terracotta horse & ship, angle measurement instruments (45°, 90°, 180°)
Rakhigarhi	Haryana	—	One of largest IVC sites , granary, cemetery, drains, terracotta bricks
Ropar	Punjab	Sutlej	Dog buried with human (oval pit burial), copper axe
Balathal & Kalibangan	Rajasthan	—	Bangles factory, toy carts, camel bones, decorated bricks, citadel & lower town
Surkotda	Gujarat	—	First actual horse bone remains in IVC
Banawali	Haryana	Dried Saraswati	Toy plough, barley, grams, lentils, fire altar, oval-shaped settlement, only city with radial pattern streets
Alamgirpur	UP (Meerut)	Yamuna	Easternmost IVC site , copper broken blade, ceramic items
Mehrgarh	Pakistan	—	Pre-IVC origin site , pottery & copper tools

Key Takeaways

- IVC marks the **earliest urban civilisation** in the Indian subcontinent
- **Scientific town planning**: grid layout, advanced drainage, water supply
- **Metropolitan culture**: brick houses, public baths, granaries
- **Mastery in sculpture**: bronze (lost wax), steatite seals, terracotta, stone
- **Trade network**: seals found in Mesopotamia
- **No cow depiction** on any seal
- **Undeciphered script** — still a mystery
- **Archaeological Survey of India (ASI)** continues excavations
- Drainage system arguably **superior to many modern cities**

Mauryan & Post-Mauryan Architecture & Sculpture

From the earliest urban civilisation, we move into the era of empires. The Mauryan period marks the first state-sponsored art in India, followed by the dynamic developments of the Post-Mauryan age.

Timeline Context

- **Indus Valley Civilization** → ended ~1500 BC
- **Vedic Period** → ~1500 BC to ~500 BC
- **Second Urbanization** → starts ~500 BC → rise of **Buddhism** & **Jainism** (both part of **Śramaṇa tradition** — non-Vedic, opposed varna/jati system; supported by Kshatriya rulers)
- **322 BC** → Mauryan Empire established

Mauryan Art (322 - 185 BC) — Two Categories

Category	Patronage	Includes
Court Art (court art)	State initiative	Palaces, pillars, stupas
Popular Art (popular art)	Individual initiative	Caves, pottery, sculptures

1. Court Art

Palaces

- First powerful empire in India
- Capitals: **Pataliputra** & **Kumrahar** (both in modern **Bihar**)
- **Chandragupta Maurya's palace** → inspired by **Persepolis** (Achaemenid palace, Iran)
- Principal building material: **Wood**
- **Megasthenes** called it "greatest creations of mankind"
- **Ashoka's palace at Kumrahar**: massive structure, **high central pillar**, **3-story wooden structure**, walls decorated with carvings & sculptures

Ashokan Pillars

Feature	Detail
Height	~40 ft
Material	Chunar sandstone
Structure	4 parts: Shaft (monolith) → Capital (lotus-shaped / bell-shaped) → Abacus (circular/rectangular base) → Animal figure atop
Influence	Achaemenid — bell shape & polished lustrous finish
Key examples	Lauria Nandangarh (Champaran), Sarnath (Varanasi)
Sarnath pillar	Abacus + Animal part = National Emblem of India

Stupas

- **Vedic origin**: burial mounds for relics/ashes (funerary)
- **Ashoka's reign**: climax of first phase; ~**84,000 stupas** constructed
- Buddhism adopted the tradition

9 original stupas after Buddha's death: Rajgriha, Vaishali, Kapilavastu, Allakappa, Ramagrama, Vethapida, Pava, Kushinagar, Pippalivana

Stupa Parts: - **Core** → unburnt brick - **Outer surface** → burnt bricks + thick plaster layer - **Medhi** (terrace) & **Torana** (gateway) → decorated with wooden sculpture - **Vedika** (railing), **Pradakshina patha** (circumambulatory path for worship)

Famous stupas: - **Sanchi Stupa (MP)** → most famous - **Piprahwa Stupa (UP)** → oldest

2. Popular Art

Rock-Cut Caves

- **First emergence** of rock-cut cave architecture in India
- Used as **Viharas** (living quarters) for Buddhist/Jain monks
- Early caves used by **Ajivika sect** followers
- Later became **Buddhist monasteries**
- Special features: **highly polished interior finish, decorative gateways**

Examples: - **Barabar & Nagarjuni Caves (Bihar)** → built 320–185 BC under **Dasharatha** (Ashoka's grandson)

Sculptures

- Used for: decorating stupa torana/medhi, religious expression
- **Most famous: Yaksha & Yakshi** sculptures
- Worshipped in **Hinduism, Jainism, Buddhism**
- **Yakshi** mentioned in **Silapadikaram** (Sangam Tamil text)
- Each **Jain Tirthankara** associated with a **Yakshi**

Pottery — Northern Black Polished Ware (NBPW)

- **Black paint + highly lustrous finish**
- Used as **luxury items**

Post-Mauryan Period (from 2nd century BC)

Dynasties & Religious Sects

Region	Dynasties
North	Shunga, Kanva, Kushana, Shakas
South & West	Satavahana, Vakataka, Abhira, Vakataka

New Brahmanical sects: Shaivites, Vaishnavites, Shaktas

Post-Mauryan Architecture

Rock-Cut Caves — Two Types

Type	Period	Use	Features
Vihara	Mauryan (continued)	Residential halls for monks	—
Chaitya	Post-Mauryan	Prayer halls	Quadrangular chambers, flat roof, open courtyard, stone screen walls (rain protection), decorated with human/animal figures

Examples: - **Karla Chaitya Hall** (near Mumbai) - **Ajanta Caves** (Maharashtra): 29 caves — 25 viharas + 4 chaityas - **Udayagiri & Khandagiri Caves (Odisha)**: built by **Kalinga king Kharavela** (1st-2nd century BC), near Bhubaneswar; both excavated & natural caves; possibly for Jain monks - **Udayagiri: Hathigumpha inscription** (famous) - **Rani Gumpha: double-story cave** with beautiful sculptures

Stupas

- Became **larger** and more **decorative**
- **Stone** replaced wood/brick
- **Shunga dynasty** introduced **Toranas** as beautifully decorated gateways → intricately carved with figures/patterns
- Best examples: **Bharhut Stupa (MP)**, **Sanchi Stupa**

Post-Mauryan Sculpture — Three Major Schools

1. Gandhara School (Greco-Indian School of Art)

Aspect	Detail
Location	Western frontiers of Punjab → modern Peshawar & Afghanistan
Period	50 BC - 500 AD (two stages)
Influence	Greek invaders brought Greek & Roman sculpture traditions → merged with local
Stage 1	Blue-grey sandstone
Stage 2	Mud & stucco

2. Mathura School

Aspect	Detail
Location	Banks of Yamuna River
Period	1st-3rd century BC
Influences	Buddhism, Jainism, Hinduism
Symbolism	Hindu gods represented by weapons/attributes (e.g., Shiva by linga / mukhalinga)
Buddha's halo	Larger size , decorated with geometric patterns
Bodhisattvas	Padmapani (holds lotus) & Vajrapani (holds thunderbolt)

3. Amaravati School

Aspect	Detail
Location	Krishna & Godavari river valleys (South India)
Patrons	Satavahana rulers
Focus	Dynamic images & Narrative art (contrast: Mathura focused on single images)
Signature pose	Tribhanga posture (body with three bends)

Conclusion

- **Mauryan**: First state influence in Indian art; **stupa architecture at its zenith**
- **Post-Mauryan**: Smaller dynasties introduced unique features; invaders/bringers also enriched artistic traditions
- Indian art = **story of continuous evolution** — each era reflects its own narratives, designs, and patterns

Nagara Temple Architecture

With Mauryan and Post-Mauryan foundations laid, Indian temple architecture began to flourish. The Nagara style of the North represents one of India's two great classical temple traditions.

Evolution of Temple Architecture in India

- **Vedic Period**: Worship centered around fire (agni)
- **3rd Century BCE**: First stone & wood structures appear
- **4th Century BCE**: Rock-cut cave temples emerge (hill regions)
- Badami Cave Temples (Karnataka)
- Udayagiri & Khandagiri Caves (Odisha)
- **5th Century CE (Gupta Period)**: Transition from rock-cut shrines to **structural (freestanding) temples** → Gupta Period = **Golden Age of India**
- Temples evolved into hubs for: education, social gatherings, festivals, marriages, markets, palaces, military garrisons

- Example: Meenakshi Temple (Madurai), Jagannath Temple (Puri) → emerged as **temple cities**

Temple Evolution in South India

- **7th Century CE - Pallava Dynasty:** Ruler **Rajasimha Varman** built monuments at **Mamallapuram**
- Rath Temples, Cave Temples, Krishna Temple, Mahishasura Mardini Mandapa, Shore Temple Complex
- Declared **UNESCO World Heritage Site in 1984**
- **Early 11th-12th Century - Chola Dynasty:** Dravidian architectural marvels
- **Brihadeshwara Temple** (Thanjavur) – built by Raja Raja I
- **Gangaikonda Cholapuram Temple** – built by Rajendra I
- **Ravateshwara Temple** – built by Raja Raja Chola II
- Collectively called: **Great Living Chola Temples**
- **Regional Styles:**
- **Vesara Style** – under Chalukyas of Badami & Hoysalas
- **Rashtrakutas** (8th Century) – Dravidian-inspired temples, e.g., **Kailash Temple (Ellora)**
- **Late 14th Century - Vijayanagara Empire:** Dominated South India → introduced **Raya Gopuram (ornate gateways)**
- Vitthala Swami Temple (Hampi)
- Virupaksha Temple (Hampi)
- → **Vijayanagara Style**

Basic Elements of a Hindu Temple

Element	Description
Garbhagriha (Sanctum Sanctorum)	Innermost chamber; principal deity installed
Mandapa	Entrance/assembly hall for worshippers
Shikhar / Vimana	Mountain-like spire above sanctum; curvilinear in North India (Shikhara), stepped-pyramidal in South India (Vimana)
Amalaka	Stone disk atop the Shikhara (mostly North Indian temples)
Kalasha	Topmost part resting on amalaka (common in North India)
Antarala	Narrow passage connecting garbhagriha and mandapa
Jagati	Raised platform in Northern temples (devotees sit & pray)
Vahana	Vehicle/mount of the main deity; positioned directly in front of garbhagriha

Classification of Temple Architecture

Three broad types: 1. **Nagara Style** (Northern) 2. **Dravidian Style** (Southern) 3. **Vesara Style** (Hybrid / Deccan)

Nagara Style - Detailed Breakdown

General Features (5th Century CE onwards)

- **Geographical extent:** From Himalayas to Vindhya ranges
- Evolved during **Gupta Period** in **5 stages**:

Stage	Example	Key Features
1st Stage	Temple No. 17, Sanchi	Flat roof, square-shaped, low platforms, shallow pillars
2nd Stage	Parvati Temple, Nachna Kuthura (MP)	Raised platforms, covered ambulatory passage (pradakshina path)
3rd Stage	Dashavatara Temple, Deogarh (UP)	Shikhara developed instead of flat roof; Panchayatana style
4th Stage	—	Square main temple with longitudinal projections
5th Stage	—	Circular-shaped temples with rectangular projections

Key Architectural Features of Nagara Style

- Built on elevated platforms
- **Panchayatana style** ground plan (main shrine + 4 subsidiary shrines)
- Mandapa (assembly hall) built directly in front of principal shrine
- Garbhagriha directly under the tallest Shikhara
- Images of **Ganga & Yamuna** goddesses carved outside garbhagriha
- Shikhara can be single or multiple
- **3 Types of Shikhara:**
 - **Rekha Prasad / Latina** – curvilinear
 - **Phamsana** – pyramidal
 - **Valabhi** – wagon-vaulted
- Fluted disc (**Amalaka**) atop Shikhara; spherical **Kalasha** topping amalaka
- Inner walls divided into **3 vertical planes** called **Ratha** (triratha, pancharatha, saptaratha, navaratha exist)
- Narrative sculptures on walls
- Garbhagriha enclosed by **covered pradakshina patha** (ambulatory passage)
- **No water tanks or gateways** (unlike Dravidian style)

Nagara Style by Region

1. Central India (UP, MP, Rajasthan)

- Material: **Sandstone**
- Classical examples:

(a) Dashavatara Vishnu Temple, Deogarh (UP)

- Late Gupta Period; classical example
- **Panchayatana style**
- **Rekha Prasad Shikhara**
- **West-facing** temple (majority are North/East-facing)
- Vishnu depicted in 3 forms on walls:
- **South wall**: Sheshshayana (reclining on Shesha)
- **East wall**: Nara-Narayana
- **West wall**: Gajendra Moksha
- Subsidiary shrines also Vishnu forms → hence called "**Dashavatara**"

(b) Khajuraho Temples (MP)

- Built **10th Century** by **Chandela rulers**
- **UNESCO World Heritage Site**
- Dedicated to **Hindu & Jain faiths**
- **64 Yogini Temple** → dedicated to Yoginis (part of Tantric worship)
- Key temples:
- **Kandariya Mahadeva Temple** – dedicated to Lord Shiva
- **Lakshmana Temple** – grandest in Khajuraho; established by Chandela King **Dhanga** in **954 CE**

2. Western India (Gujarat, Rajasthan, Western MP)

- Material: **Sandstone**
- Built under **Solanki (Chalukya) rulers**

Modhera Sun Temple (Gujarat)

- Built by Solanki king **Bhima Deva I**
- Key feature: **Surya Kund** – rectangular stepped tank (sacred water body)
- **Torana** (decorated gateway) leads to assembly hall

- Central shrine: **wall plane** (no pillars inside)
- **East-facing** → during equinox, sun rays fall directly on central shrine

3. Eastern India (North-East, Odisha, Bengal)

(a) Assam

- **10th Century**: Gupta influence visible
- **12th-14th Century**: **Ahom style** developed in Guwahati
- Ahom = mixture of **Burmese + Pala style (Bengal)**
- **Kamakhya Temple (Guwahati)** – Shakti Peetha dedicated to Goddess Kamakhya

(b) Bengal

- **9th-11th Century**: **Pala rulers** (Buddhist patrons) → **Pala style**
- Built viharas, chaityas, stupas
- **11th-13th Century**: **Sena rulers**
- Material: **Terracotta bricks** (mixture of clay)
- **Curved / sloping roof** → **Bangla roof** (later adopted by Mughals)
- Figures highly polished → **metallic & lustrous** appearance

(c) Odisha (Kalinga Style)

- Distinct **Kalinga Style**
- **Shikhara**: almost vertical with sudden inward curve at top
- **Mandapa (Jagmohan)** directly in front of the deul (shrine)
- **Exterior walls**: intricately carved; **Interior walls**: plain
- Temple surrounded by **boundary walls**
- Key examples:
- **Jagannath Temple (Puri)**
- **Lingaraja Temple (Bhubaneswar)**
- **Sun Temple (Konark)** – finest example
 - Built **1240 CE** by **Eastern Ganga Dynasty** king **Narasimha Deva I**
 - Built on raised platform; detailed carvings
 - **12 pairs of giant wheels** sculpted → represent Sun God's chariot
 - **UNESCO World Heritage Site**
 - Featured on **reverse side of ₹10 currency note**

Key Takeaways

- Nagara Style = Northern Indian temple architecture (Himalayas to Vindhya)
- Evolved from simple flat-roof squares to complex curvilinear shikharas
- 3 shikhara types: Latina/Rekha Prasad, Phamsana, Valabhi
- **Panchayatana** = main shrine + 4 subsidiary shrines
- Walls divided into vertical **Rathas** (triratha to navaratha)
- Ganga-Yamuna goddess figures outside garbhagriha
- No water tanks or gateways (unlike Dravidian)
- Major dynasties: **Gupta, Chandela, Solanki, Pala, Sena, Eastern Ganga**
- Major sites: **Deogarh, Khajuraho, Modhera, Konark, Bhubaneswar, Puri, Guwahati**

Dravidian & Vesara Temple Architecture

While Nagara architecture dominated the North, the South developed its own distinct tradition — the Dravidian style — along with the hybrid Vesara style of the Deccan.

DRAVIDIAN STYLE (Southern India)

Region: Krishna River → Kanyakumari **Key Features:** - Compound wall enclosing the temple - **Gopuram** — intricately designed entrance gateway - **Vimana** — stepped pyramidal shape (equivalent of Nagara shikhara) - **Shikhara** (in Dravidian) = the crowning element (equivalent of Nagara kalasha) - **Dwarapala** — guardian sculptures at garbhagriha entrance - Water tank inside the compound - Subsidiary shrines inside/outside main tower - **Garbhagriha** in the smallest, oldest tower - Additional boundary walls added as temple-town population grew - **Example:** Sri Ranganathar Temple, Srirangam (Tiruchirappalli) — 7 concentric rectangular enclosure walls, each with a gopuram; main shrine at center

PALLAVA ARCHITECTURE (4 stages)

Stage	Period	Ruler	Key Development
1st	610-630 CE	Mahendravarman I	Rock-cut temples → called Mandapas
2nd	630-668 CE	Narasimhavarman I	Rock-cut temples decorated with sculptures; Mandapas divided into Rathas (monolithic chariot temples). Large = Dharmaraja Ratha , Small = Draupadi Ratha
3rd	690-800 CE	Rajasimhavarman	Real structural temples (first free-standing stone temples)
4th	800-900 CE	Nandivarman	Final stage — temples were much smaller in size

Mamallapuram (Mahabalipuram)

- **Ancient port city** under Pallavas
- UNESCO World Heritage Site (1984)
- **Key Monument:** Pancha Rathas (Five Rathas) — although neighboring temples are rock-cut, these were built using **granite** → considered **earliest structural temple in South India**
- Contains shrines to **Shiva & Vishnu**
- **Unique feature:** 3 main shrines — one Shiva shrine east-facing, one Shiva shrine west-facing, one shrine dedicated to **Ananta Sayana Vishnu** (reclining Vishnu)
- Outer walls have **Nandi sculptures**
- **Site of 2nd India-China Informal Summit (2019)** — PM Modi & Xi Jinping

CHOLA STYLE (part of Dravidian tradition)

- Incorporated Pallava features with variations
- **Shaivism** dominant

Brihadeshwara Temple (Thanjavur)

- **Dedicated to:** Shiva (as Lingam in double-storey sanctum)
- **Built by:** Rajaraja Chola

- **Year:** 1010 CE
- **Significance:** Largest & tallest Indian temple; architectural grandeur
- **Vimana:** Pyramidal, ~70m high; topped with **dome-shaped shikara** with Nandi images; crowned by **3m 8cm tall kalasha**
- **Decorations:** Murals & sculptures of mythological stories on surrounding walls

Gangaikonda Cholapuram Temple

- **Built by:** Rajendra I
- **Year:** 1035 CE
- **Shape:** Square plan
- **Dedicated to:** Shiva; also depicts Vishnu, Durga, Surya, Harihara
- **Considered:** South India's largest Shiva temple (along with Brihadeshwara)

Airavateshwara Temple (Thanjavur)

- **Built by:** Rajaraja Chola II
- **Century:** 12th Century CE
- **Dedicated to:** Shiva
- **Key detail:** Mandapa pillars intricately carved with stories — Parvati's penance, Shiva's marriage, Shiva's fight with Asuras
- **Miniature panels:** Depict stories of **63 Nayanars (Shaiva saints)** → evidence of Chola belief in Shaivism

UNESCO: All three Chola temples declared World Heritage Sites in 1987 (as "Great Living Chola Temples")

VESARA STYLE (Deccan / Karnataka Style)

Period: Mid-7th Century CE **Nature:** Hybrid of Nagara + Dravidian styles **Borrowed from Nagara:** Curvilinear shikhara + square base **Borrowed from Dravidian:** Stepped shikhara + intricate carvings

Three Dynasties that developed Vesara: 1. **Chalukyas** (Badami & Kalyani) 2. **Rashtrakutas** 3. **Hoysalas**

Key Examples

Pattadakal Temples

- **UNESCO World Heritage Site**
- **10 temples total:** 4 Nagara style, 4 Dravida style, 1 Jain temple, 1 Papanatha temple (Vesara style)
- **Virupaksha Temple:** Built by Queen Lokamahadevi (wife of Vikramaditya II) in 733 CE — Dravidian style

Aihole

- **Durga Temple** — classical Vesara example
- **Khan Temple** — classical Vesara example

HOYSALA ARCHITECTURE (Vesara sub-style)

Period: 1050–1300 CE **Prominence:** After decline of Cholas & Pandyas **Locations:** Belur, Somnathpur, Halebidu **Distinctive Features:** - **Panchayatana style** predominantly adopted - **Star-shaped (stellate) ground plan** — new evolution by Hoysalas - **Main building material:** Chloritic schist (soapstone)

Key Temple: Hoysaleswara Temple (Halebidu) — classical example

RASHTRAKUTA ARCHITECTURE

Founded by: Dantidurga (735 CE) **Capital:** Manyakheta (Malkhed) **Religious tolerance:** Patronized all religions; adopted Pallava style

Kailash Temple (Ellora, Aurangabad, Maharashtra)

- **Builder:** Krishna I (Rashtrakuta)
- **Century:** 8th Century CE
- **Context:** Ellora Caves — 34 caves total (Buddhist, Jain, Hindu); Kailash is the **largest Hindu cave temple**
- **Construction:** Carved from **single monolith** top-down
- **Labor:** ~7,000 workers, >100 years
- **Dimensions:** 276 ft long × 154 ft wide
- **Shape:** Modeled on Mount Kailash
- **Entrance:** Small gopuram with life-size elephants

- **Subsidiary shrines:** 5 around main temple — dedicated to Ganga, Yamuna, Saraswati
- **Main temple:** 3-storey with sabhagriha, Nandi mandapa, garbhagriha (Shivalinga)
- **Notable carvings:** Ardhanarishwara, Veerabhadra (Shiva), Ravana shaking Mount Kailash, Ramayana & Mahabharata stories
- **Significance:** Considered the **climax of rock-cut temple architecture in India**

Elephanta Caves (Rashtrakuta)

- **Total caves:** 7 — 2 Buddhist (east) + 5 rock-cut Hindu (west)
- **Main temple:** Dedicated to Lord Shiva
- **Entrance:** 7m high **Sadashiva (Trimurti)** — depicts Shiva's 3 forms: Creator, Preserver, Destroyer
- **Sculpture: Vishala Mahesha Murti** — Shiva center, Uma & Bhairava on sides

VIJAYANAGARA STYLE

Capital: Hampi, Karnataka **Influences:** Chola + Hoysala + Pandya + Chalukya + Islamic architecture of Bijapur **Key Features:** - **Massive gopurams (Raya Gopurams)** — built on all 4 sides - Multiple mandapas; **central mandapa = Kalyana Mandapa** - **Secular buildings** concept emerged

Hampi — UNESCO World Heritage Site Key Temples: - Vitthala Swami Temple - Lotus Mahal - Virupaksha Temple - Raghunatha Temple - **Narasimha on Sesha (snake) idol** — architectural beauty

ROLE OF TEMPLES (Socio-Economic-Artistic)

Positive: - **Employment hub:** Artisans, craftsmen, priests, cooks, musicians, dancing girls - **Urbanization catalyst:** Commercial activities → markets → inland trade boost - **Land grants (Devadana):** Temples received land gifts - **Agriculture:** Water tanks, canals, land reclamation - **Education:** Traditional subjects (Vedas, grammar, logic) + Mathematics, Astronomy, Astrology taught; schools & colleges attached to temples; **free boarding & lodging** for students - **Artistic hub:** Musicians & dancers appreciated; art passed generationally - **Example:** Kanchipuram — Uttara Merur inscription mentions educational functions

Negative: - **Perpetuated caste system:** Brahmins given religious exclusivity - **Devadasi system:** Girls dedicated to deity worship & service; initially high social status → later exploited for menial jobs (temple cleaning) & sexual exploitation by upper-caste men - **Present status:** Devadasi system banned as social evil

QUICK REFERENCE — Temple-Dynasty-Style Map

Temple	Dynasty	Style	Key Feature
Pancha Rathas, Mamallapuram	Pallava	Dravidian (structural)	Granite; 3 main shrines
Brihadeshwara, Thanjavur	Chola	Dravidian	Tallest vimana (70m)
Gangaikonda Cholapuram	Chola	Dravidian	Square plan, multi-deity
Airavateshwara, Thanjavur	Chola	Dravidian	63 Nayanar panels
Virupaksha, Pattadakal	Chalukya	Dravidian	Built by queen
Durga Temple, Aihole	Chalukya	Vesara	Classical example
Hoysaleshwara, Halebidu	Hoysala	Vesara (stellate)	Star-shaped plan
Kailash Temple, Ellora	Rashtrakuta	Rock-cut Dravidian	Monolith, top-down
Elephanta Caves	Rashtrakuta	Rock-cut	Trimurti (7m)
Vitthala Swami, Hampi	Vijayanagara	Vijayanagara	Raya Gopurams

Islamic Art & Architecture (Medieval India)

From indigenous temple traditions, we turn to the arrival of Islam in India, which brought a new architectural vocabulary of arches, domes, and minars, creating the Indo-Islamic synthesis.

Key Term

- **Indo-Islamic Architecture** (aka **Indo-Saracenic Architecture**): Fusion of Persian & Indian styles after Islamic rule in India.

Features of Indo-Islamic Architecture

- **Arches & Domes** gained prominence — called **Arcuate style**
- **Minars** (towers) built around mosques & assembly halls
- **Sculptures avoided** (against Quran); replaced by **Calligraphy** as decoration

- **Arabesque** patterns: vegetation (flowers/leaves) in geometric stem-forms
- **Geometry** heavily used as design principle
- **Intricate Jali (lattice) work** — shows importance of light in Islam
- **Water features**: religious, cooling & decorative purposes
- **Charbagh style**: square block divided into 4 identical gardens
- **Pietra dura**: inlaying precious stones into stone walls
- **Foreshortening technique**: inscriptions designed for depth-perception

Delhi Sultanate Period (1206-1526 CE)

A. Imperial Style (Delhi Rulers)

1. Slave Dynasty (1206-1290) — Mamluk Style

- Mostly **remodeled existing Hindu structures**
- **Qutub Minar** (5-storey):
 - Ground floor — Qutubuddin Aibak (initiated)
 - Next 3 floors — Iltutmish (completed)
 - 5th floor — Firoz Shah Tughlaq
- **Quwwat-ul-Islam Mosque** (Qutub Minar premises)
- **Adhai Din Ka Jhonpra** (Ajmer)

2. Khilji Dynasty (1290-1320) — Seljuk Style

- **Red sandstone** hallmark
- **Arcuate style** began here
- Large-scale use of **mortar**
- Monuments: **Alai Darwaza** (by Alauddin Khilji), **Siri Fort**

3. Tughlaq Dynasty — "Crisis period" for architecture

- **Grey sandstone** used
- Focus on **strength**, less on decoration
- **Sloping walls** for strength
- Arch + lintel both used for entrances
- Monuments: **Tomb of Ghiyasuddin Tughlaq**, **Tughlaqabad**, **Jahanpanah**, **Firozabad**

4. Lodhi Dynasty — Architectural decline, only tombs built

- **Double Dome** introduced:
- Outer dome — aesthetics
- Inner hollow dome — internal symmetry
- Tombs: **solid, no decoration, octagonal shape**
- **Lodhi Gardens; City of Agra** (by Sikandar Lodhi)

B. Provincial Schools of Architecture

1. Bengal School

- **Bricks & Black marble** main materials
- **Sloping Bangla roofs** (continued from temple tradition)
- Monuments: **Kadam Rasul Mosque** (Gaur), **Adina Mosque** (Pandua)

2. Malwa / Mandu School (aka **Pathan School**)

- Different colored stones & marbles
- **Large windows** with arches & pillars
- **No minars**
- Famous for **environmental adaptation**: ventilation, large windows, artificial reservoirs, local materials
- Monuments: **Jahaz Mahal, Rani Roopmati Pavilion, Ashrafi Mahal**

3. Jaunpur School (aka **Sharqi Style**)

- Patronized by **Sharqi rulers**
- **No minars**
- Bold & forceful painted characters on sides & center of prayer halls
- Monument: **Atala Mosque** (Jaunpur)

4. Bijapur School (aka **Deccan Style**)

- Patron: **Adil Shah**
- **Three-arch facade & Bulbous domes**
- Focus on **cornice decoration**
- **Iron clamps** + strong mortar for strength
- Walls decorated with **rich carvings**
- Monuments: **Gol Gumbaz, Adil Shah's Majlis**

Mughal Architecture (1526-)

- **Peak of Indo-Islamic Architecture** — greatest exchange of ideas & styles

Babur (1526-1530)

- Built mosques in **Panipat & Rohilkhand** (1526)
- **Kabuli Bagh Mosque** (Panipat) — after victory over Ibrahim Lodhi
- Introduced **Charbagh garden style**
- Short reign — no major new styles/techniques

Humayun (1530-1540, 1555-1556)

- Continuous power struggle with Sher Shah — could not focus on art
- Founded city **Din Panah** (unfinished)
- **Persian style** remained prominent

Sher Shah Suri (1539-1555) — Sur Dynasty

- **Qila-e-Kuhna** (Purana Qila, Delhi)
- **Rohtas Fort** (Pakistan)
- **Sher Shah Suri Mosque** (Patna) — **Afghan style**
- His reign = **transition from Lodhi to Mughal style**
- Renovated ancient road → renamed **Sadak-e-Azam** → later **Grand Trunk Road**
- Built **serais (rest houses)** for travelers
- **Tomb at Sasaram** (Bihar, Rohtas district): red sandstone, situated in a lake

Akbar (1556-1605) — Golden Period begins

- **Red sandstone** principal material
- Introduced **True Arch / Four-centered Arch**
- **Agra Fort:**
- Started under Akbar; most interior structures under Shah Jahan
- Key buildings: **Moti Masjid, Diwan-e-Aam, Diwan-e-Khas, Jahangiri Mahal, Sheesh Mahal**
- Gardens in **Charbagh style**
- **Fatehpur Sikri** — capital city, "frozen moment in history" (unique Hindu + Persian mix)

- **Buland Darwaza** (40m, red sandstone, 1576 CE) — Akbar's Gujarat victory; world's largest gateway
- **Tomb of Salim Chishti** (1581) — white marble, exquisite jali work, arabesque walls
- **Panch Mahal** — 5-storey columnar structure, concept of Persian **badgir (wind catcher)**
- **Jodhabai Palace** & **Mariam-uz-Zamani Palace** — interior motifs of bells & flowers (Hindu)
- **Ibadat Khana** — interfaith discussions
- **Pachisi Court** — where Akbar played chess
- **Hiran Minar** — memorial for Akbar's favorite elephant Hiran; also served as lighthouse

Jahangir (1605-1627)

- More focused on **painting** than architecture
- **Akbar's Tomb** (Sikandra)
- **Jahangir's own tomb** (Lahore)
- **Shalimar Bagh** (Kashmir)
- **Moti Masjid** (Lahore)
- **White marble replaced red sandstone** as chief building material
- **Tomb of Itimad-ud-Daula** (built by Nur Jahan):
- First fully white marble Mughal structure
- Finest **pietra dura** & **low-relief carvings** (on plain background)

Shah Jahan (1628-1658)

- **Taj Mahal** (mentioned as reference point)
- **Red Fort** (Delhi)
- **Jama Masjid** (Delhi)
- **Shalimar Bagh** (Lahore)
- **Shahjahanabad** city
- **Peacock Throne** — finest of the period

Aurangzeb (1658-1707) & After

- **Decline** of Mughal architecture
- **Muhammad Azam Shah** (last Mughal to build):

- **Bibi Ka Maqbara** (Aurangabad) — mother Rabia Daurani's tomb, called "poor imitation of Taj Mahal"
- **Zeenat Mahal** (Delhi)

Conclusion

- Islamic architecture in India began with Delhi Sultanate, saw ups & downs
- **Mughal architecture** = peak / **zenith of Islamic art** in India
- Greatest exchange of ideas & styles between local & foreign traditions
- Key elements: arches, vaults, domes, ornamental decoration
- Mughal architecture also synthesized **Deccan & regional styles**

Modern Architecture (India)

The Islamic period gave way to European colonial influence, which reshaped Indian architecture through Portuguese, French, and British styles, followed by post-Independence modernist responses.

Context

- Covers **European Colonial influence** on Indian architecture (Portuguese → French → British) followed by **Post-Independence** architectural developments.
- European arrival coincided with Mughal decline → power struggle among Portuguese, French, Dutch, Danish, British.

1. Portuguese Influence

- **Style introduced:** Iberian Style (pre-dates Roman art; originated in Spain & Portugal)
- **Later style:** Baroque Style (developed in late 16th-century Europe for dramatic church interiors; used elaborate details, contrasting dark/light colours)
- **Concepts introduced:** Patio houses, Baroque style
- **Early constructions:** Trading posts & warehouses → later remodelled into fortified towns

Notable Portuguese Constructions

Building	Location	Year	Style
Se Cathedral	Goa	1619 AD	Late Gothic
Basilica of Bom Jesus	Goa	1604 AD	Baroque (UNESCO World Heritage Site)
Castella de Aguada (St. Paul's Church)	Mumbai	1610 AD	—
Fort at Diu Island	Diu	1535 AD	— (has a lighthouse)

2. French Influence

- **Key contribution:** Introduced **urban city planning**
- **Style:** Cartesian Grid Plan + Scientific architectural designs
- **Concept introduced: Anonymous Architecture** — building fronts are simple, no ornamentation/design
- **Cities developed:** Pondicherry (Puducherry), Chandernagore (West Bengal), Mahé (Kerala), Karaikal (Tamil Nadu)

Notable French Constructions

Building	Location
Church of Sacred Heart of Jesus	Puducherry
Sacred Heart Church	Chandernagore

3. British Influence

- Most **dominant colonial power** → most significant architectural impact.

3A. Indo-Gothic Style (a.k.a. Victorian Style)

- **Fusion of:** Indian (native) elements + Gothic Style
- **Characteristics:**

- Extremely large & elaborate constructions
- Walls were **thinner** compared to Indo-Islamic constructions
- **Pointed arches** (not curving arches)
- **Large windows** — unique feature
- Church floor plan = **Crucifixion (cross) shape**
- First use of **steel I-beams & filled concrete**
- **Also called:** Victorian Style

3B. Neo-Roman Style (a.k.a. Neo-Classical Style)

- Emerged **after 1911** (when capital shifted to Delhi)
- **Also called:** Rome of Hindustan
- **Key architects: Edwin Lutyens & Herbert Baker** — designed New Delhi
- **Characteristics:**
 - Anonymous style (no interesting ornamentation/design)
 - **Hybrid nature** — mixed all architectural styles → eclectic look
 - Simplicity, modernity, and utility sometimes compromised
 - **Focus on circular buildings**
 - Introduced **Up-Turn Dome** (purely ornamental/decoration feature; no structural importance)
 - Example: Supreme Court of India, Rashtrapati Bhavan

Notable British Constructions

Building	City	Style
Victoria Memorial	Kolkata	Indo-Gothic
Gateway of India	Mumbai	Indo-Gothic
New Delhi (entire city)	Delhi	Neo-Roman (by Lutyens & Baker)
Rashtrapati Bhavan	Delhi	Neo-Roman (Up-Turn Dome)
Supreme Court of India	Delhi	Neo-Roman (Up-Turn Dome)
Connaught Place	Delhi	Designed by Charles Correa (later)

4. Post-Independence Architecture (After 1947)

- **Two schools emerged:**
- **Revivalist** — wanted to revive traditional Indian styles
- **Modernist** — wanted modern/Western styles
- **Problem:** Both could not fully break free from colonial influence → **standard of Indian architectural tradition declined**

Key Figures

Architect	Known as / Contribution	Key Works	Awards
Le Corbusier (French)	Hired by Punjab Govt.	Designed Chandigarh city	—
Laurie Baker	"Architect of the Poor"	Revolutionized mass housing in Kerala; used environment-friendly, locally available materials ; focused on ventilation & thermal comfort	Nominated for Pritzker Prize (2006) — "Nobel of Architecture"
Charles Correa	Adapted modern architectural principles to local Indian needs	Madhya Pradesh Assembly Building, Mahatma Gandhi Memorial Museum (Ahmedabad), LIC Building, Connaught Place (Delhi)	Padma Vibhushan (2006)

Laurie Baker — Key Features

- Environment-friendly buildings
- Locally available materials
- Emphasis on ventilation & thermal comfort

Charles Correa — Key Works

- Madhya Pradesh Assembly Building
- Mahatma Gandhi Memorial Museum, Ahmedabad
- LIC Building

- Connaught Place, Delhi

Quick Reference Table: All Colonial Styles at a Glance

Colonial Power	Style(s) Introduced	Key Features	Key Cities / Sites
Portuguese	Iberian → Baroque, Late Gothic	Patio houses, fortified towns, dark/light colour contrast, elaborate detailing	Goa, Mumbai, Diu
French	Cartesian Grid Plan, Anonymous Architecture	Urban planning, grid layout, simple facades, scientific design	Pondicherry, Chandernagore, Mahé, Karaikal
British	Indo-Gothic (Victorian) → Neo-Roman (Neo-Classical)	Thin walls, pointed arches, large windows, cruciform churches, steel/concrete; later: circular buildings, up-turn domes, hybrid/eclectic	Kolkata, Mumbai, New Delhi

Key Terms Glossary

Term	Meaning
Iberian Style	Pre-Roman architecture from Spain/Portugal
Baroque Style	Late 16th-cent. European style; dramatic, elaborate, contrasting colours
Anonymous Architecture	Simple building fronts, no ornamentation
Cartesian Grid Plan	Systematic grid-based city layout (French)
Indo-Gothic / Victorian	Indian + Gothic fusion (British)
Neo-Roman / Neo-Classical	Post-1911 British style; hybrid, circular, up-turn domes
Up-Turn Dome	Purely ornamental dome (no structural role)
Revivalist School	Post-1947; wanted to revive traditional Indian styles
Modernist School	Post-1947; wanted modern/Western styles
Pritzker Prize	"Nobel of Architecture"

Indian Paintings - Part 1

Architecture tells only part of the story. Equally rich is India's painting tradition, spanning from prehistoric rock art through classical murals to intricate miniature paintings.

Evolution of Indian Paintings

- **Prehistoric Period** (50,000 BCE – 6,000 BCE) → Paleolithic, Mesolithic, Neolithic, Chalcolithic
- Earliest evidence: **Bhimbetka Caves** (Bhopal, MP) – 600+ painted caves
- Paintings engraved on floor/roof/walls = **Murals**
- Prehistoric rock paintings = **Petroglyphs**
- Key prehistoric sites: **Bhimbetka** (MP), **Pachmarhi** (MP), **Mirzapur** (UP)
- Later: **Fresco paintings** – wet plaster + pure colors, religious/spiritual themes

Sadanga - Six Principles of Indian Painting (Vatsyayana, Kamasutra, Gupta Period)

#	Term	Meaning
1	Rupa-bheda	Appearance / understanding of form
2	Pramanam	Correct proportion, measurement & structure
3	Bhava	Mood / emotional expression of figures
4	Lavanya-yojana	Artistic grace / grace rendered artistically
5	Sadrishya	Similarity / likeness
6	Varna-kabhang	Artistic use of brush & colors

- Gupta Period murals & frescos: finest examples in **Ajanta & Ellora Caves** (Buddha's life, religious/mythological scenes)

Medieval Period - New Schools Emerge

- **Mughal, Rajput, Deccani** styles originate
- **Modern Period** (19th century – present) → Western influence → **Bengal School, Progressive Artists' Society**

Four Categories of Indian Paintings

1. **Mural** – walls/solid structures
2. **Miniature** – small medium, intricate
3. **Modern** – post-19th century, Western influence
4. **Folk** – regional/traditional

MURAL PAINTINGS

- Origin: ~10th century BCE – 10th century CE
- Natural or man-made caves
- Themes: **Hinduism, Buddhism, Jainism**
- Key sites: Ajanta, Ellora, Bagh, Badami, Arma Malai, Ravana Chhaya, Sittanavasal, Kailashnath Temple

1. Ajanta Caves (Maharashtra, Aurangabad)

- **UNESCO World Heritage** | Sahyadri ranges, Wagora river
- **200 BCE - 650 CE** | 29 caves, **horseshoe** layout
- Associated dynasties: **Maurya, Gupta, Shunga**
- Theme: **Buddhist**
- Bold **red outlines** for figures; pigments still vibrant
- Famous paintings: **Padmapani, Vajrapani, Manjushri, Dying Princess, Apsara**

2. Ellora Caves (100 km from Ajanta)

- 100 caves (34 open): **17 Hindu, 12 Buddhist, 5 Jain**
- **Kailashnath Temple** – world's largest rock-cut Hindu temple; built by **Rashtrakuta ruler Krishna I**
- Murals in **5 caves**; created in **two stages** (during carving + centuries later)
- Distinctive features: twisted heads, bent arms, plump limbs, pointed noses, bulging eyes

3. Bagh Caves (Madhya Pradesh)

- 9 Buddhist caves
- Technique: **orange mud plaster + lime** coating over walls & ceilings
- Similar to Ajanta but with **thicker colors, bolder outlines, highly modeled figures**
- Themes show **secularism**

4. Badami Caves (Bagalkot, Karnataka)

- **6th century** rock-cut temples
- Large figures of **Vishnu avatars**; fully adorned with mural paintings
- **One of India's oldest murals**
- Figures: **graceful, compassionate, sensitive expressions**
- Similar to Ajanta & Bagh but more refined
- **UNESCO World Heritage**

5. Other Mural Sites

Site	Location
Arma Malai Caves	Tamil Nadu
Sittanavasal Caves	Tamil Nadu
Ravana Chhaya Rock Shelter	Odisha
Lepakshi Temple	Andhra Pradesh
Jogimara Caves	Chhattisgarh

MINIATURE PAINTINGS

- Emerged after **paper invention** – shift from walls to small media
- Size: **never > 25 sq inches**
- Medium: **paper, palm leaves, fabric**
- Known for: intricate detailing, first-class brushwork
- Themes: **religious & non-religious Indian literature**
- **Five sub-categories**

A. Early Miniature Paintings

Pala School of Painting

- **Oldest miniature style** in India
- Theme: **Buddhist**
- Reflects **Nalanda & Vikramashila** heritage
- Medium: **palm leaves; light colors, sinuous/curved lines**
- Famous work: **Ashtasahasrika Prajnaparamita** (Buddhist manuscript)

Apabhramsa School of Art

- Region: **Gujarat, Rajasthan, Malwa**
- Period: **11th - 15th century**
- Initially **Jain** → later **Vaishnava** influence
- Works include: **Gitagovinda** (Radha-Krishna) + Jain iconography
- Famous manuscripts: **Kalpasutra, Kalkacharya Katha**

B. Transition Period Miniature (14th century - "Phase of Change")

- **Islamic influence** due to Muslim rulers in North India
- **Vijayanagara Empire** (South) → new style similar to **Deccani**
- Features:
 - **Rich colors, bold black outlines**
 - Faces at **three-quarter angle** → 3D appearance
 - Detailed backgrounds: rivers, mountains, trees, animals

C. Delhi Sultanate Miniature (14th century)

- **Persian elements + Indian touch**
- Paintings for **manuscript illustrations**
- Example: **Nimmat Nama** (Nasir Shah's reign)
- Laid foundation for **Mughal, Rajput & Deccan schools**

D. Mughal Era Miniature Paintings

General features: - Heavy **Persian influence** - Shift from religious themes → **court scenes, hunting, historical events, royal life** - **Naturalistic style** (Persian) - **Bright, shiny colors** - **Geometry principles** → special visual effect

Mughal Rulers & Patronage

Ruler	Key Contribution
Babur	Patronized Persian artist Bihzad ; commissioned painted family tree album – foundation of Mughal painting
Humayun	Met Abdus Samad & Mir Sayyid Ali in Persia; brought them to India; Tutinama manuscript
Akbar	Established Tasvir Khana (formal art studio); salaried Indian & Persian artists; realistic paintings, dramatic expressions, 3D figures, calligraphy. Famous artists : Daswanth, Basawan, Kesu. Works : Tutinama, Hamzanama, Anwar-i-Suhayli, Gulistan of Saadi
Jahangir	Golden Period of Mughal Miniature. Preference: nature paintings (animals, birds, plants), portraits . Naturalism & realism. Decorated margins/frames. Famous painter : Ustad Mansur. Works : Zebra portrait, Turkey Cock, Ayare Danish album
Shah Jahan	Artificial elements over naturalism; European influence . Used pen, pencil, sketch, charcoal; heavy gold & silver . Painters : Mohammad Nadir Samarqandi, Mir Hashim

Indian Paintings — Part 2

Continuing our survey of Indian painting, we examine the decline of Mughal miniatures, the rise of regional schools, modern movements, and India's vibrant folk painting traditions.

1. Decline of Mughal Miniature Painting

- **Aurangzeb**, an orthodox Islamic ruler, stopped patronizing painters
- Painters migrated to other kingdoms → Mughal painting declined
- Miniature painting's final category: **Regional Miniatures** (covered in next lecture)

2. Regional Schools of Miniature Painting

Developed under the patronage of regional kingdoms.

A. Rajasthan School of Painting (aka Rajput School of Painting)

- Originated & developed in Rajput kingdoms of Rajasthan
- Influenced by Mughal miniatures
- **Major Sub-Schools:**

i. Mewar School

- Based on **Vaishnavism** themes
- Subjects: Ramayana, Bhagavata Purana, popular poems & stories like **Rasika Priya** and **Ragamala**
- Famous painter: **Sahib Din**
- Later shift to secular themes: darbar scenes, royal ceremonies
- **Tamasha paintings** also popular

ii. Jaipur School (aka Dhundar School)

- Development largely due to **Maharaja Sawai Pratap Singh**
- Examples found on palace walls and **Amer Mahal** cenotaphs
- Themes similar to Mewar School

iii. Marwar School

- Developed under **Maharaja Man Singh**
- Covers Jodhpur & Bikaner areas
- Themes: Vaishnavism + **Shaivism** (Shiv Purana, Nat Charitra, Durga Charitra, Panchatantra)
- Unique features: colorful clothing of figures, bright colors
- **Two sub-schools:**
- **Kishangarh School**
 - Mainly Radha-Krishna paintings
 - Unique features: long necks, arched eyebrows, thin lips, wide eyes
 - Famous painting: **Bani Thani**
 - Famous painters: **Savant Singh, Nagari Das, Nihal Chand**
- **Bundi School**
 - Known for **naturalism** and **realism**
 - Themes: Lord Krishna's life

iv. Kota School

- Kota & Bundi styles share similarities → together called **Hadoti School of Miniature Painting**
- Themes: Krishna bhakti, **tiger & bear hunting**
- Kota & Bundi paintings have strong resemblance

B. Pahari School of Miniature Painting

- Developed in Himalayan hill states
- Subjects: mythological stories to Indian literature
- Multiple figures on canvas, all energetic & distinct
- **Two greatest painters: Nainsukh and Mank**
- **Two major sub-schools:**

i. Basohli School

- First patron: **Raja Kripal Pal**
- Unique features: **bold & dark colors**
- Based on famous poems
- Famous works: **Ras Manjari** (painter Devidas), **Geet Govindam** (painter Mank)

ii. Kangra School

- Known for **delicate softness** and **naturalistic appearance**
- Most famous painting: Portrait of **Maharaja Sansar Chand of Kangra** (by descendants of Nainsukh)

C. Miniature Painting Styles of South India

- Different from North Indian miniatures
- **Spiritualism dominates** themes (not royal life)
- Beautiful depictions of Hindu gods & goddesses
- **Extensive use of gold**
- **Major sub-schools:**

i. Tanjore School

- Patronized by **Marathas**
- Biggest contribution: **Maharaja Sarfoji II**

- Painted on **glass or wooden plaques** using bright colors

ii. Mysore School

- Two or more figures in one painting
- One figure is dominant in **size and color**

3. Modern Indian Paintings

A. Company Paintings

- Developed during colonial rule as amalgamation of Rajput, Mughal, Pahari, South Indian & **European elements**
- British painters in India blended Indian paintings with European elements
- Followed in: Kolkata, Chennai, Delhi, Patna, Varanasi, Thanjavur
- **Features:**
- First use of **water colors**
- Modern painting & **shading techniques**
- Themes: Indian landscapes, **flora & fauna**
- Famous painters: **Mazhar Ali Khan, Ghulam Ali Khan**

B. Bazaar Paintings

- European influence visible but different from Company Paintings
- Fusion of European techniques/themes with Indian techniques/themes
- **Roman & Greek elements** also seen
- Prevalent in **Bihar & Bengal**
- Greco-Roman heritage + Indian bazaar scenes with European background
- Religious subjects were painted, but **Ganesha-like deities prohibited** (deviated from European natural human form)

C. Bengal School

- Developed to counter European influence & revive indigenous Indian techniques
- Story begins **early 20th century**
- **Abanindranath Tagore** launched his painting album "**Arabian Nights**"
- Features: Simple colors, reflection of **Swadeshi values**
- Iconic works:

- **Bharat Mata** (Abanindranath Tagore)
- **Mahatma Gandhi sketch** (Nandalal Bose)

D. Raja Ravi Varma

- **Father of Modern Indian Paintings**
- Fused South Indian painting elements with **Western painting & color techniques**
- Themes: mythological stories & literary works
- Famous paintings: Lady in the Moonlight, Shakuntala, Damayanti, Swan, Ravana Kidnapping Sita

E. Cubist Style of Painting (India)

- Inspired by **European Cubist movement**
- Uses **modern art techniques** + geometry principles to show objects from every angle
- Perfect balance of geometry & colors
- Famous painter: **M.F. Husain**
- His work: "**Personification of Romance**" — beautiful example of cubist form & abstract style

F. Progressive Artists' Group (PAG)

- Formed in **1947** by a local group of painters
- Bold colors on progressive themes
- Based on **abstract art forms** & soft themes
- **Founder: Francis Newton Souza**
- Eminent members: **S.H. Raza, H.A. Gade, M.F. Husain**

4. Folk Paintings of India (Folk/Lok Kala)

Art developed among common people.

A. Madhubani Art (Bihar)

- Folk art from **Mithila region (Bihar)** & **Terai region (Nepal)**
- Origin legend: First painted during **Lord Rama & Sita's wedding** (Ramayana era)
- Materials: **Rice paste, cow dung, vegetable colors**
- Made during festivals & auspicious occasions

- Primarily by **women**
- Themes: Hindu gods & goddesses, natural elements (sun, moon, trees, flowers, animals, birds)
- **GI Tag** awarded
- Famous painters: **Jagdamba Devi, Bhua Devi, Bharti Dayal, Ganga Devi**

B. Pattachitra (Odisha)

- Sanskrit: "Patta" = cloth, "Chitra" = painting
- **Classical + folk elements** combined
- Inspired by **Vaishnavism** and **Jagannath culture**
- Painted on **cotton cloth** using natural colors
- Colors sourced from: **burnt coconut shells, hingula, ramaraja, lamp black**
- **No pencil sketch or pen used** — figures outlined directly with brush
- After painting, **lac coating** gives shiny appearance
- Sometimes made on **palm leaves** → called **Tal Pattachitra**

C. Patua Art (Bengal)

- Folk art of Bengal, started ~**1000 years ago**
- Themes: gods & goddesses
- Painted on **cloth scrolls (pats)**
- Historically: Patua artists traveled singing mythological stories
- Today: used for **social & political campaigns**
- Note: These Hindu-themed paintings are made by **Bengal's Muslim population** — example of **Ganga-Jamuni tehzeeb** (composite culture)

D. Kalighat Paintings (Kolkata)

- Started in **19th century** by rural migrants near **Kalighat Temple, Kolkata**
- **Water colors** on neutral background
- Early themes: religion & spirituality
- Later shifted to: **social issues**
- Current trends: **women empowerment, romantic, satirical themes**

E. Patkar Paintings (Jharkhand)

- Made by **Jharkhand's tribal communities**

- Ancient history → known as **one of the oldest schools of painting**
- Themes: Tribal goddess **Maa Mansa**
- Also: religious customs, **non-conventional subjects** (e.g., what happens to human body after death)

F. Kalamkari (Andhra Pradesh)

- "Kalam" = pen, "Kari" = work
- Painted on **cotton cloth** using bamboo pens
- Colors: mainly **vegetable-extracted**
- Also uses **fermented jaggery water** for coloring
- Practiced in: **Sri Kalahasti & Machilipatnam** (Andhra Pradesh)
- **GI Tag** awarded

G. Warli Paintings (Gujarat & Maharashtra)

- Originated ~**2500-3000 BCE** by the **Warli tribe**
- Resemble **Bhimbetka cave paintings**
- **Central motif:** square/rectangle (chauk/chaukat) surrounded by paintings
- Themes: hunting, farming, dancing, animals, trees, festivals
- Depicts **Palghat** (Goddess of Fertility) & other deities
- Uses **geometric symbols:** triangles, circles, squares
- Painted on **mud or cow dung base**
- Color: **white** (made from gum + rice)
- Well-known tribal art form

H. Thangka Paintings

- Made in: **Sikkim, Himachal Pradesh, Ladakh, Arunachal Pradesh**
- Dedicated to **Buddhism**
- Painted on **cotton canvas** using bright and shiny colors
- Colors have **philosophical significance:**
- **Red** → passion & intense emotions
- **White** → peace
- **Black** → anger
- **Green** → human consciousness
- Considered one of the most beautiful & meaningful painting forms

Handicraft

From painting, we turn to India's rich handicraft tradition — decorative and functional objects made by hand that have sustained livelihoods for centuries.

Definition

- **Handicraft:** Any decorative/functional object made by hand (no machines)
- Low capital investment, provides livelihood; India = major producer & supplier
- Materials: cloth, ivory, terracotta, silver, clay, etc.

1. Cloth Handicrafts

Tie & Dye Techniques

Technique	Description	Regions
Bandhani / Bandhej (Tie & Dye)	Cloth tied with rubber in patterns, dipped in dye; tied areas resist colour	Rajasthan, Gujarat
Leheriya	Tie & dye creating ripple/wave patterns	Jaipur, Jodhpur
Ikat	Tie & dye applied on yarn before weaving	Telangana, Odisha, Gujarat, Andhra Pradesh

Hand-Printing & Weaving

Artform	Description	Region
Kalamkari	Hand-painting on cloth using vegetable dyes	Andhra Pradesh
Batik	Multicolour batik sarees & dupattas	Madhya Pradesh, West Bengal
Jamdani	Opaque patterns on transparent muslin fabric	West Bengal
Tanchoi	Chinese-inspired fine miniature-painting-like weave; came via trade routes	Surat, Gujarat

2. Glassware

Ancient Evidence

- Earliest material evidence: ~1000 BCE, Painted Grey Ware culture, Ganga Valley
- Called **Kaanch** in Satapatha Brahmana
- **Lenticular beads** (lens-shaped) from Brahmapuri & Kolhapur, Maharashtra
- Chalcolithic sites: Maski, Ahar (Rajasthan), Hastinapur & Ichchhatar (UP), Eran & Ujjain (MP)

Medieval Period

- Mughals patronised glass art (Shish Mahal, glass hookahs, perfume boxes, engraved glasses)

Modern Glass Centres

Centre	Speciality
Hyderabad	Glass bangles (Choodi ka Joda)
Firozabad, UP	Glass bangles, chandeliers, decorative pieces
Saharanpur, UP	Panchkoti — children's glass toys
Patna, Bihar	Tikuli — decorative glass beads (used by Santhal tribe)

3. Ivory Crafting

- Called **Danta** in Vedic period
- Harappan period: ivory objects (dice etc.) exported to Turkmenistan, Afghanistan, Persian Gulf
- 2nd century BCE: Sanchi inscriptions mention ivory
- 2nd century CE: Taxila ivory comb found
- Mughal period: combs, dagger handles, ornaments
- **Traditional centres**: Delhi, Jaipur, parts of West Bengal
- Famous items: caskets, palanquins (**Palki**), **Ambari elephant**, Kerala ivory paintings, Jodhpur ivory bangles, Jaipur ivory **jali work**

4. Terracotta Crafts

- **Meaning:** "Baked earth" — a ceramic clay used for sculpture, architecture, pottery, bricks
- **Key examples:**
 - **Bankura Horse & Panchmura Horse** (Bankura district, West Bengal)
 - Terracotta temples in Bankura
 - 8th-century Pala period Buddhist viharas (best specimens)
 - **Somapura Mahavihara** (Naogaon, Bangladesh — UNESCO World Heritage Site)

5. Silver Jewellery

Technique / Item	Description	Region
Filigree work	Intricate metalwork technique for jewellery	—
Penri / Pajeman	Silver anklets	Odisha
Gunchi	Unique silver-woven ornaments	—
Bidri work	Silver inlaid on dark background	Bidar village, Karnataka

6. Clay & Pottery Work

- Called "**Lyric of Handicrafts**" — moulded like poetic composition
- Earliest evidence: **Mehrgarh, Pakistan** (Neolithic site)

Ancient Pottery Types

Type	Period	Features
Painted Grey Ware (PGW)	1500–600 BCE (Vedic)	Grey colour
Red & Black Pottery	1500–300 BCE	Found in large parts of West Bengal
Northern Black Polished Ware (NBPW)	700–100 BCE (two phases; Mauryan period)	—
Rouletted Pottery	200–100 BCE	Arikamedu, Puducherry (max evidence)
Gupta period (300–600 CE)	New decorative techniques: embellishments, painting, stamping, moulding	
Indo-Islamic tradition	Glazed pottery	

Regional Pottery (Modern)

Type	Origin	Features
Khurja Pottery	UP	Colourful, sturdy; household items
Black Pottery	Azamgarh, UP	Dark tint/shade
Glazed Tiles	Lucknow, UP	Special glazing technique
Others	—	Blue pottery, Kagaji pottery, Dal Gate pottery

7. Bronze Crafts

- Bronze = copper + tin
- Earliest literary evidence: **Matsya Purana**
- Ancient India: metal used more for weapons than art
- Famous example: **Dancing Girl** from Mohenjo-daro

- **Major centres (UP):** Etawah, Sitapur, Varanasi, Moradabad
- Products: flower pots, god/goddess images, decorative items
- **Tamil Nadu:** influenced by Pallava, Chola, Pandya art — bronze statues

8. Metal & Leather Crafts

Metal Techniques

Technique	Description	Example
Engraving	Carving designs on metal base	Mori work (Rajasthan); pots in Moradabad
Embossing	Raised designs above base metal	—
Damascening	Precious metals inlaid on dark background	Koftagiri (Rajasthan)

Leather Crafts

- Evidence from ~3000 BCE to Mughal period
- Modern use: footwear, bags, wallets
- **Largest market:** Rajasthan (camel leather products)
- **Jaipur & Jodhpur:** **Mojadi** (footwear)
- **Kanpur, UP:** leather products
- **Kolhapur, Maharashtra:** **Kolhapuri chappals**
- **Chennai & Kolkata:** leather bags & footwear
- **Punjab:** **Jutti**
- **Bikaner:** **Manauti art**

9. Other Art Forms (Toys, Dolls)

- Evidence from Harappan civilization
- Materials: clay, paper, papier-mâché, painted/shiny wood
- **Tirupati dolls** (red wood) & **Ambari elephant** (soft wood) — famous toy art of Andhra Pradesh
- Rajasthan, Assam, southern states also known for toys

10. Embroidery

Type	Region	Description
Applique	Pipli village, Odisha	—
Phulkari	Punjab, Delhi, Haryana	Floral patterns
Gota	Rajasthan	Gold thread designs
Zari work	Khandela & Jaipur, Rajasthan	Gold/silver thread on silk
Chikankari	Lucknow	Defines Lucknow's cloth-making culture
Kashida	Kashmir	Embroidery on Kashmir shawls
Himroo shawls	Aurangabad	—
Maheshwari sarees	Madhya Pradesh	Cotton + silk + golden zari
Mirror work	Gujarat	Small glass pieces fixed on fabric

Conclusion

- Handicrafts practised since ancient times in Indian culture
- British rule caused large-scale decline, but Indian handicrafts survived
- Recent years: revival & continued practice

Indian Music — History, Structure & Types

Having explored the visual arts, we now turn to the auditory — India's profound musical tradition, from its Vedic origins through the classical Hindustani and Carnatic systems.

□ Historical Evolution

Period / Source	Key Detail
Muni (sage)	Introduced musical art on Earth
Indus Valley Civilization	7-folded flute & Ravan Hatha (instrument remnants) found
Vedic Times (~2000 yrs ago)	First literary musical sources. Samaveda mentions all 7 notes of raga Kharahar Priya in descending order
Gandharva Veda	Upaveda of Samaveda; called Science of Music
Aitareya Aranyaka	Mentions Veena instrument
Jaiminiya Brahmana	Describes dance & music
Later Vedic Period	Ritualistic music: Sangam & Jati Gan — text lines sung in musical patterns
Bharata Muni — Natyashastra (200 BC-200 AD)	First major text; describes 22 Shrutis (keys) and music chapters
Matanga — Brihaddeshi (9th Century)	First to define the word "Raga"
Sarangadeva — Sangeet Ratnakara (13th Century)	Defines 264 ragas
Nanda — Sangeet Makarand (11th Century)	Information on ragas
Rama Matya — Swara Mela Kalanidhi	Information on ragas
Gurukul System	Ancient & medieval period — students lived with teachers to learn music

□ Anatomy (Structure) of Indian Music

3 Pillars: **Raga** + **Tala** + **Swara**

Swara (Notes / Pitch)

- Originally linked to **Veda recitation**
- Natyashastra: **22 Shrutis**
- Modern Hindustani: **Saptak / Sargam** — 7 notes: **Sa Re Ga Ma Pa Dha Ni**
- English equivalent: **Pitch**

Raga

- Sanskrit root "**Ranj**" = to delight / make happy
- **Basis of melody** — evokes a personality, subject, or mood
- Built from notes

Types by Number of Notes:

Type	Notes	Name
Odhav	5	Pentatonic
Shadhav	6	Hexatonic
Sampoorna	7	Heptatonic

Types by Purity:

Type	Meaning
Shuddha Raga	Pure — no mixture of another raga
Chhaya Alag Raga	Mixture of 2 ragas
Sankirna Raga	Mixture of >2 ragas

Aroha & Avaroha:

- **Aroha**: Ascending notes (each higher than previous)
- **Avaroha**: Descending notes

6 Major Ragas (Time & Season based)

Raga	Time	Season
Bhairav	Dawn	All seasons
Hindol	Morning	Spring
Deepak	Night	Summer
Megh	Late night	Rainy
Shri	Evening	Winter
Malkosh	Midnight	Winter

Raga Components:

1. Rasa (Emotion evoked) — **Nauras (9 Rasas)**

Rasa	Emotion
Shringar	Love
Hasya	Humor / Laughter
Karuna	Pathos / Courage
Raudra	Anger
Bhayanak	Horror
Veer	Bravery
Adbhut	Wonder
Vibhatsa	Disgust
Shanta	Peace

2. Thaata — System to classify ragas into groups

3. Samay — Time of day for performance (raga effective only at prescribed time)

Tala (Rhythm)

- Rhythmic grouping of beats in a composition
- Range: **3 to 108 beats**
- Used to measure musical **time** (musical meter)
- **Independent** of main music
- **Laya** = Tempo / speed of tala
- Hindustani & Carnatic have different tala systems

□ Classification of Indian Music (4 Categories)

1. □ Classical Music — 2 Types

(A) Hindustani Music (North India)

- Diverged from Carnatic in **14th Century**
- Roots: **Natyashastra**
- Focus: Musical structure & improvisation possibilities
- Adopted **Shuddha Swar Saptak** (octave of natural notes) — 8 notes occupying intervals between 2 notes
- **10 Main Singing Styles:** Dhrupad, Dhamar, Hori, Khayal, Tappa, Chaturang, Rag Sagar, Tarana, Sargam, Thumri

□ Dhrupad

- **Oldest & grandest** style of Hindustani classical
- Mentioned in Natyashastra
- Name: **Dhruv** (fixed) + **Pad** (poetry) = poetry + singing method
- Established: 13th Century; **Peak under Emperor Akbar**
- Akbar patronized: **Gopal Das, Swami Haridas, Tansen** (Tansen = one of Navratnas)
- **Declined after 18th Century**
- Extended presentation; elaborate raga treatment
- **Dhruv** = unmoving → notes, time, text are fixed
- Starts with **Alap** (wordless), then Dhrupad begins

- Instruments: **Pakhavaj + Tanpura**
- Uses **Sanskrit syllables**
- Performed by **2 people**
- **4 Forms (Vani) / Gharanas:**

Gharana	Family / Performers	Features
Dagari Gharana	Dagar family (Muslims sing Hindu gods/goddesses)	Emphasis on Alap. Ex: Gundecha Brothers (Jaipur)
Darbhangha Gharana	Malik family — Ram Chatur Malik, Prem Kumar Malik, Siyaram Tiwari	Khand Vani & Gauharbani
Bettiah Gharana	Mishra family — Indra Kishore Mishra	Nohar & Khand Vani
Talwandi Gharana	—	—

□ Khayal

- Persian word = **Idea / Imagination**
- Origin credited to **Amir Khusro**
- Based on **short songs of 2-8 lines**
- Composition = **Bandish**
- Greatest patron: **Sultan Mohammad Sharqi** (15th Century)
- Uses **Taana** (instead of Alap) — faster tempo = unique feature
- Theme: Romantic; also sung for divine beings / God / King; **Lord Krishna** has exceptional compositions
- **5 Gharanas:**

Gharana	Origin / Founders	Key Performers	Features
Gwalior	—	Nathu Khan, Vishnu Paluskar	Focus: Melody & Rhythm
Kirana	Kirana Town, UP. Founder: Nayak Gopal. Popularized by: Abdul Karim Khan, Abdul Wahid Khan	Pandit Bhimsen Joshi, Gangubai Hangal	Expression, tuning, note expression
Agra	Revived by Faiyaz Khan (also called Rangila Gharana)	Mohsin Khan Niyazi, Vijay Kichlu	Blend of Khayal & Dhrupad
Patiala	Under Patiala Maharaja's patronage (19th Century)	Bade Ghulam Ali Khan (greatest vocalists)	Greater rhythm & emotions; intricate taans & alankars
Bhendi Bazar	Originated 19th Century	—	Breath control training; uses some Carnatic ragas

□ Tarana

- Rhythm plays crucial role
- Short melody repeated in variations
- Uses many words sung at **fast tempo**
- **World's fastest Tarana singer: Pandit Ratan Mohan Sharma** (Mewati Gharana)
— title: **Badshah of Tarana**

□ Semi-Classical Styles

- Note-based like classical but **lighter versions** of ragas (e.g., Bhopali, Malkosh) + lighter tala + medium/drut laya (faster tempo)
- Emphasis: **Bhaav (emotion) & Lyrics**

Style	Details
Thumri	Mixed ragas; romantic/devotional; influenced by Bhakti Movement ; mostly about Lord Krishna; language: Hindi / Awadhi / Braj Bhasha; usually female voice. 2 types: Poorvi Thumri (slow tempo), Punjabi Thumri (fast). Main gharanas: Banaras, Lucknow. Famous: Begum Akhtar
Tappa	Rhythm important; originated from camel riders' folk songs (NW India); recognized at Mughal emperor Muhammad Shah's court . Unique: Quick turning of phrases. Going extinct . Performers: Mian Sodi, Pt. Laxman Rao (Gwalior), Shanno Khurana
Ghazal	Poetic form; rhythmic couplets. Origin: 10th Century Iran . Spread via Islamic sultanates & Sufi saints. Expresses love despite loss/pain . Max: 12 Ashaar (couplets) . Traditional subject: only Love (God or human). Initially only upper class understood. Famous: Mohammad Iqbal, Mirza Ghalib, Rumi (13th C), Hafiz (14th C), Kazi Nazrul Islam

(B) Carnatic Music (South India)

- Played in **traditional octave**
- Based on **Kriti**; focus on **literary / lyric quality**
- **Kriti** = highly evolved musical song bound to a raga + fixed tala
- **Structure of Carnatic Composition:**

Part	Description
Pallavi	1st or 2nd thematic lines; repeated each stanza — best part of composition. Ragam Thanam Pallavi — artist gets scope for improvisation
Anupallavi	Follows Pallavi (2 lines); sung at beginning & sometimes end; not necessarily repeated after every stanza
Varnam	Sung at beginning of recital to reveal raga to audience. 2 parts: Purvanga (1st half) + Uttara (2nd half)
Raga Malika	Usually concluding part of performance; singer fully free to improvise but must return to original theme
Swara Kalpana	Improvised section; performed at medium & fast pace with drummer
Instrument: Mridangam	Melody with Mridangam = Thanam . Parts without Mridangam = Ragam

2. Folk Music

3. Fusion of Classical & Folk (4 types)

Type	Description
Sugam Sangeet	Light classical
Rabindra Sangeet	Tagore's compositions
Haveli Sangeet	Temple music
Gana Sangeet	Patriotic / mass music

4. Modern Music

- Rock, Pop, Blues, Trance, Jazz, Psychedelic Music
- Recent trend: Fusion of classical + pop/jazz etc.

□ Differences: Hindustani vs Carnatic

Aspect	Hindustani	Carnatic
Influence	Arab, Persian, Afghan	Purely indigenous
Sub-styles	Many → Gharana system developed	Single style of singing
Instruments vs Vocals	Instruments = equally important as vocals	Emphasis on vocals
Number of Ragas	6 major ragas (time-bound)	72 ragas (time not strictly followed)
Major Instruments	Tabla, Sarangi, Sitar, Santoor	Mridangam

□ Key Instruments Mentioned

Instrument	Context
Veena	Aitareya Aranyaka
7-folded Flute	Indus Valley
Ravan Hatha	Indus Valley
Pakhavaj	Dhrupad
Tanpura	Dhrupad
Tabla	Hindustani major instrument
Sarangi	Hindustani
Sitar	Hindustani
Santoor	Hindustani
Mridangam	Carnatic

□ **Key Personalities / Musicians**

Name	Association
Bharata Muni	Natyashastra (22 Shrutis)
Matanga	Brihaddeshi (defined Raga)
Sarangadeva	Sangeet Ratnakara (264 ragas)
Nanda	Sangeet Makarand
Rama Matya	Swara Mela Kalanidhi
Tansen	Mughal court Navratna; patronized by Akbar
Gopal Das	Dhrupad, Akbar's court
Swami Haridas	Dhrupad, Akbar's court
Amir Khusro	Origin of Khayal style
Sultan Mohammad Sharqi	Patron of Khayal
Nathu Khan	Gwalior Gharana (Khayal)
Vishnu Paluskar	Gwalior Gharana
Nayak Gopal	Kirana Gharana founder
Abdul Karim Khan	Popularized Kirana Gharana
Abdul Wahid Khan	Popularized Kirana Gharana
Pandit Bhimsen Joshi	Kirana Gharana
Gangubai Hangal	Kirana Gharana
Faiyaz Khan	Revived Agra Gharana (Rangila)
Mohsin Khan Niyazi	Agra Gharana
Vijay Kichlu	Agra Gharana
Bade Ghulam Ali Khan	Patiala Gharana; greatest vocalists
Pandit Ratan Mohan Sharma	Mewati Gharana; fastest Tarana singer; "Badshah of Tarana"

Name	Association
Gundecha Brothers	Dagari Gharana (Dhrupad)
Ram Chatur Malik	Darbhangha Gharana
Prem Kumar Malik	Darbhangha Gharana
Siyaram Tiwari	Darbhangha Gharana
Indra Kishore Mishra	Bettiah Gharana
Begum Akhtar	Thumri
Mian Sodi	Tappa
Pt. Laxman Rao (Gwalior)	Tappa
Shanno Khurana	Tappa
Mohammad Iqbal	Ghazal
Mirza Ghalib	Ghazal
Rumi (13th C)	Ghazal
Hafiz (14th C)	Ghazal
Kazi Nazrul Islam	Ghazal

□ Key Texts / Treatises

Text	Author	Century	Significance
Natyashastra	Bharata Muni	200 BC–200 AD	22 Shrutis; music chapters
Brihaddeshi	Matanga	9th C	First defined "Raga"
Sangeet Ratnakara	Sarangadeva	13th C	Defined 264 ragas
Sangeet Makarand	Nanda	11th C	Raga info
Swara Mela Kalanidhi	Rama Matya	—	Raga info
Gandharva Veda	Upaveda of Samaveda	—	Science of Music

Indian Music – Folk, Fusion & Modern Music

Building on classical music foundations, we now explore the folk, fusion, and modern music that connect India's classical heritage to its living soundscape.

1. Fusion of Classical & Folk Music

- **Bridge:** Devotional music connects royalty (classical) and common people (folk) through worship, creating fusion.
- **Sugam Sangeet** – Devotional genre blending classical + folk; influenced by Prabandh Sangeet and Dhrupad.

Sub-categories of Sugam Sangeet

Bhajan

- **Region:** North India
- **Origin:** Bhakti Movement – saints spread God's message through hymns
- **Features:** Simple lyrics set to melody; sung in one or more ragas; subjects = God/goddess lives, Mahabharata, Ramayana
- **Instruments:** Chimta, Dholak, Duffli, Manjira
- **Exponents:** Tulsidas, Meera Bai, Surdas, Kabir

- **Modern singers:** Anup Jalota, Anuradha Paudwal

Shabad

- **Context:** Sung in Gurudwaras in devotion to Sikh Gurus
- **Origin:** Popularized by Guru Nanak & his disciples
- **3 Types:**
 - Raag Shabad singing
 - Traditional Shabad (mentioned in Adi Granth)
 - Lighter ones – no strict rules/ragas

Qawwali

- **Purpose:** Sung in praise of Allah, Prophet Muhammad, Islamic saints / Sufis
- **Languages:** Urdu, Punjabi, Hindi + Braj & Awadhi words
- **Venue:** Sufi shrines
- **Composition:** Single raga
- **Performance:** Solo or group; 2 lead singers + 8-member team
- **Instruments:** Tabla, Dholak, Harmonium
- **Structure:** Intensity / tempo builds gradually → signifies devotee reaching transcendent (otherworldly) stage
- **Origin:** Attributed to Amir Khusro (disputed)
- **Famous Qawwals:** Sabri Brothers, Nusrat Fateh Ali Khan, Aziz Warsi

Gan Sangeet

- **Format:** Choral / group singing
- **Purpose:** Patriotic feelings, protest songs, social message propagation (e.g. stop exploitation of women & children)
- **Example:** Vandemataram (national song)

Haveli Sangeet

- **Region:** Rajasthan & Gujarat (now across India)
- **Origin:** Sung in temple premises; now sung outside too
- **Practiced by:** Pushti Marg Sampraday community

2. Rabindra Sangeet

- **Region:** Bengal

- **Creator:** Nobel laureate Rabindranath Tagore
- **Style:** Mix of classical elements + Bengali folk trends
- **Themes:** Devotion to one true God, nature & its beauty, celebration of life, **patriotism**

3. Modern Music

- **Key trait:** Complete freedom from traditional conventions (rhythm, melody, etc.)

Rock Music (Indian Rock)

- Indian elements blended into mainstream rock while retaining global rock features
- Mutual influence: Western rock → Indian rock **AND** Indian classical → Western rock
- **First Indian rock singer:** Usha Uthup

Jazz in India

- **Origin:** 1920s, Bombay – by African-American jazz musicians
- **Golden Age:** 1930–1950
- Black musicians migrated to India to escape racial discrimination in USA
- **Similarity with Indian classical:** Improvisation evolves naturally in both
- **Fusion born → Indo-Jazz**
- **Pioneers:** Ravi Shankar (sitar), John Coltrane

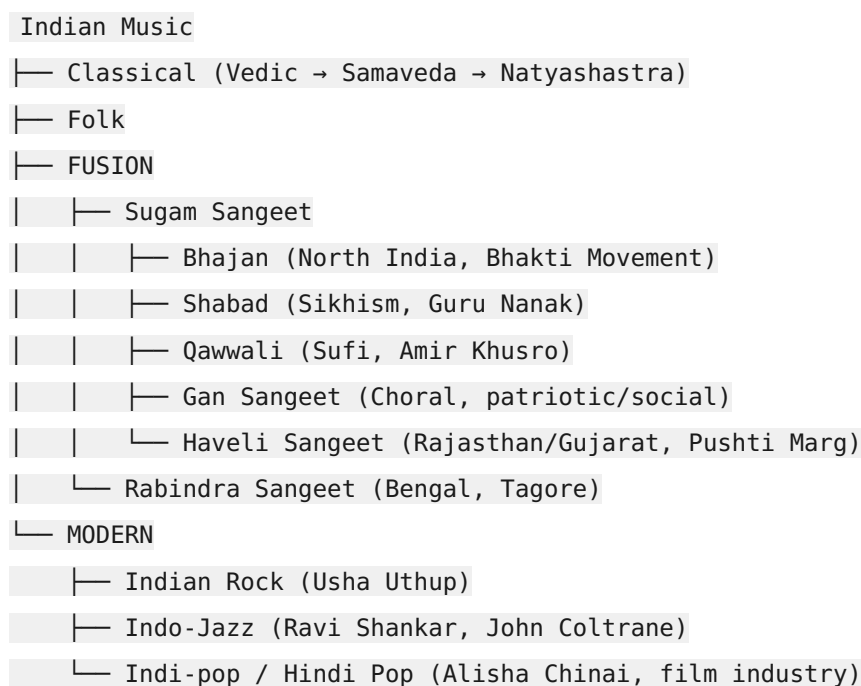
Pop Music (Indi-pop / Hindi Pop)

- Indian elements combined with pop
- **Popularized by:** Alisha Chinai (early 1990s)
- **Source:** Mostly from Indian film industry

4. Key Instruments Mentioned

Instrument	Context
Veena, Mridangam, Mandolin	Carnatic (major)
Flute, Violin	Common to both Hindustani & Carnatic
Chimta, Dholak, Duffli, Manjira	Bhajan
Tabla, Dholak, Harmonium	Qawwali

Quick Revision - Flowchart



Indian Classical Dance Forms

Music and dance are inseparable in Indian culture. We now examine the eight classical dance forms rooted in Bharata Muni's Natya Shastra.

Key Foundational Concepts

- **Classical (Shastriya)**: Dance forms mentioned in ancient texts/shastras
- **Primary Source**: Natya Shastra by **Bharat Muni**

- **Evolution period:** Contemporary forms developed from musical plays between **12th-19th century**
- Other sources: inscriptions, genealogies of kings & artists

Two Major Aspects

Aspect	Meaning	Symbolism
Lasya	Grace, emotion, rasa	Feminine features
Tandava	Movements, rhythm	Masculine features

Three Components (Natya, Nritta, Nritya)

1. **Natya** — Dramatic element; imitating characters
2. **Nritta** — Basic dance movements (pure rhythm)
3. **Nritya** — Mudras (gestures) & expressions (abhinaya)

Nine Rasas (Navarasas)

#	Rasa	Emotion
1	Shringar	Love
2	Raudra	Anger
3	Vibhatsa	Disgust
4	Veer	Valor
5	Shant	Peace/calmness
6	Hasya	Laughter/comic
7	Karuna	Tragedy/pathos
8	Bhayanak	Fear
9	Adbhut	Wonder/amazement

8 Recognized Classical Dance Forms

1. Bharatanatyam

- **State:** Tamil Nadu (South India)
- **Key Text:** Abhinaya Darpana by **Nandikeshwara**
- **Nature:** Solo dance (**Ek-harya**) — one dancer plays multiple roles
- **Movements:** Transitional movements of feet, hips, arms; expressive eyes & hand gestures
- **Orchestra:** Mridangam, Violin, Veena, Flute, Cymbals
- **Conductor:** **Natuvanan**
- **7 parts:** Alarippu → Shabdam → Varnam → Padam → Thalana → Shloka → Jati Swaram
- **Depicted at:** **Chidambaram Temple** gopuram (gate), Tamil Nadu
- **Revived by:** **E. Krishna Iyer** & **Rukmini Devi Arundale**

2. Kathak

- **Region:** North India
- **Word origin:** Katha = story
- **Original context:** Villages/temples — storytellers narrated ancient scriptures
- **Evolution:**
- **15th-16th century:** Bhakti movement → **Rasleela** folk plays (Radha-Krishna)
- **Mughal period:** Court performances under Mughal emperors
- **Nawab Wajid Ali Shah** (Awadh) — major patron
- **Features:** Solo performance; verses recited then executed via movements; emphasis on **footwork**; controlled movements; **Ghungroo** (ankle bells); straight-legged stance
- **Only classical form connected to Hindustani (North Indian) music**
- **Revived by:** **Lady Leela Sokhey** (aka **Menaka**)

3. Kathakali

- **State:** Kerala
- **Nature:** Synthesis of music, vocal, dance, hand & face gestures
- **Unique element:** Incorporates **ancient Indian martial arts** & athletic traditions of South India

- **Development setting:** Courts & theatres of Hindu principalities (unlike temple/monastery origins of other forms)
- **Influenced by:** **Chakiar Koothu, Krishnanattam, Koodiyattam, Ramanattam**
- **Story source:** Indian epics
- **Costume:** Heavy makeup, large masks, long skirts, large headdresses
- **Face colors:**
- **Green** = Nobility
- **Black** = Demonic/evil
- **Red patches** = Royalty + evil combination
- **Technique:** Hand gestures, facial expressions, eye movements are critical; body weight on outer edges of slightly bent feet
- **Key exponents:** **Raman Kutty Nair & Kalamandalam Gopi**

4. Kuchipudi

- **State:** Andhra Pradesh (Krishna district)
- **Origin:** Village named **Kuchipudi** in Krishna district
- **Also known as:** **Yakshagaan**
- **17th century:** Kuchipudi style envisioned by **Siddhendra Yogi** (guided by **Teerth Narayan Yogi** who composed Krishna Leela Tarangini in Sanskrit)
- **Formats:** Dance drama (groups) + solo items
- **Costume:** Elaborate ornaments & jewelry
- **Solo Items:**
- Manduk Shabdham — story of a frog maiden
- Bal Gopal Tarang — dancing with water pot on head, standing on brass plate edges
- Tala Chitra Nritya — drawing pictures with toes while dancing
- **Key exponents:** **Yamini Krishnamurti & Raja Reddy**

5. Mohiniattam

- **State:** Kerala
- **Type:** Classical solo dance for women
- **Name:** Mohini = female avatar of Lord Vishnu
- **References:**
- Vyavahara Mala (1709) by **Madamangalam Narayana Namboodiri**
- Ghosh Yatra by poet **Kunjan Nambiar**

- **Shaped into classical format** (18th–19th century) by: **Maharaja Kartika Tirunal** & **Maharaja Swati Tirunal** (Travancore)
- **Movements**: Circular movements, delicate steps, subtle expressions
- **Borrowed from**: Nangiar Koothu + folk dances Kaikottikali & Tiruvathirakali
- **Style**: Elements of both Bharatanatyam (grace) & Kathakali (vigor), but more **erotic, lyrical, delicate**
- **Costume**: Realistic makeup, **Kerala Kasavu saree**
- **Language of lyrics**: **Mani Pravalam** (Tamil + Malayalam + Sanskrit)
- **Key exponents**: **Pallavi Krishnan** & **Sunanda Nair**

6. Odissi

- **State**: Odisha
- **Themes**: Stories of Vishnu avatars + verses from Jayadev's **Geet Govind**
- **Nature**: Soft dance, soothing lyrics, resembles Bharatanatyam in mudras & emotions
- **Also called**: **Mobile Sculpture**
- **Two main postures**:
- **Tribhanga** — body deflected at neck, torso & knees
- **Chauk** — square-like position
- **Key exponents**: **Sonal Mansingh** & **Kelucharan Mahapatra**

7. Sattriya

- **State**: Assam
- **Introduced**: **15th century AD** by **Shankar Dev** (Vaishnav saint & reformer)
- **Purpose**: Medium for propagating Vaishnav faith
- **Name origin**: Associated with **Sattras** (Vaishnav monasteries)
- **Principles**: Strictly governed rules for hand mudras, footwork, aharya (costume), music
- **Two streams**:
- Related to traditional Assamese drama **Bhaona** — from Gayan Bhanar Nach to Khar Manar Nach
- Independent dance numbers: **Chali** (graceful/elegant), **Rajaghadiya Chali**, **Jhumura** (vigorous/majestic), **Nadu**

8. Manipuri

- **State:** Manipur
- **Origin:** Ancient (pre-recorded history)
- **Context:** Connected to rituals & traditional festivals
- **Legendary references:** Shiva, Parvati & other deities creating the universe
- **Lai Haraoba** — earliest dance form, basis of all stylized dances
- Meaning: "Merry making of Gods"
- Ceremonial offering of song & dance
- Performers: **Maibas** (priests) & **Maibis** (priestesses)
- Reenacts the creation of the world
- **Rasleela dances:** Originated in **18th century** under **Raja Bhagya Chandra**

Quick Reference Table

Dance Form	State	Key Exponents	Unique Feature
Bharatanatyam	Tamil Nadu	E. Krishna Iyer, Rukmini Devi Arundale	Ek-harya; Chidambaram temple depictions
Kathak	North India	Lady Leela Sokhey (Menaka)	Footwork, ghungroo; only form tied to Hindustani music
Kathakali	Kerala	Raman Kutty Nair, Kalamandalam Gopi	Martial arts influence; elaborate makeup
Kuchipudi	Andhra Pradesh	Yamini Krishnamurti, Raja Reddy	Yakshagaan tradition; toe-painting
Mohiniattam	Kerala	Pallavi Krishnan, Sunanda Nair	Solo female; circular movements
Odissi	Odisha	Sonal Mansingh, Kelucharan Mahapatra	Tribhanga & Chauk postures; "Mobile Sculpture"
Sattriya	Assam	—	Sattri-linked; two streams (Bhaona + independent)
Manipuri	Manipur	—	Lai Haraoba; Maiba/Maibi priests

Indian Folk Dances

Alongside classical dance, India's folk dance traditions offer a vibrant window into community life — spontaneous, celebratory, and deeply tied to regional identity.

General Characteristics of Indian Folk Dances

- **Definition:** Folk art = common property of a group/community; originator forgotten but style preserved across generations
- **Occasions:** Arrival of seasons, childbirth, weddings, festivals, any joyful event
- **Nature:** Simple, spontaneous, no professional training required; performed by locals
- **Performance:** Dancers sing themselves + accompanying musicians with instruments
- **Distinct features:** Each form has unique costume, rhythm, colorful attire with heavy jewelry/designs
- **Cultural role:** Helps understand India's diverse cultural terrain; each state/region has its own folk dance traditions

1. Chhau (छाऊ)

- **Type:** Tribal martial art dance
- **States:** Odisha, Jharkhand, West Bengal
- **3 Sub-genres:** | Genre | State | |-----|-----| | Purulia Chhau | West Bengal | | Seraikela Chhau | Jharkhand | | Mayurbhanj Chhau | Odisha |
- **Occasion:** Vasant Utsav (spring festival) — 13 days; Chaitra Parva
- **Performance:** Night time, open space, by male dancers only
- **Style:** Blend of dance + martial arts; employs mock combat techniques
- **Themes:** Hindu mythology, Mahabharata, Ramayana, local folklore, abstract concepts
- **Masks:** Worn in all forms **except** Mayurbhanj Chhau
- **UNESCO:** Inscribed in Representative List of Intangible Cultural Heritage of Humanity (**2010**)

2. Kalbelia (कालबेलिया)

- **State:** Rajasthan
- **Community:** Kalbelia tribe
- **Performers:** Only women dance; men play instruments

- **Style:** Movements & costume resemble serpents; signature circular spinning (ghoomna)
- **Reputation:** One of the most **sensuous** folk dance forms
- **Occasion:** Any celebration; integral to Kalbelia culture
- **Instruments:** Khanjari (tambourine), Pungi (snake-charmer instrument)
- **Costume:** Black skirts, traditional tattoos, jewelry, small mirrors, silver-thread embroidered clothes
- **Songs:** Transmit mythological knowledge; demonstrate poetic skill; improvised during performance
- **Tradition:** Purely oral — no texts or training manuals exist
- **UNESCO:** Inscribed in Representative List of Intangible Cultural Heritage of Humanity

3. Bihu (বীহু)

- **State:** Assam
- **Performers:** Both men & women, in groups
- **Earliest evidence:** 9th century depictions in Tezpur & Darrang regions; 14th century inscriptions of Chutia King Lakshmi Narayan
- **Names:** Bihu Naas (dance), Bihu Geet (music)
- **Named after:** Bohag Bihu (Rongali Bihu) — Assamese New Year
- **3 Types of Bihu:** | Type | Month | Nature | |-----|-----|-----| | **Rongali / Bohag Bihu** | April | Spring festival, most prominent | | **Kongali / Kati Bihu** | October | Somber, scarce season | | **Bhogali / Magh Bihu** | January | Harvest festival, community feast |
- **Style:** Colorful traditional costumes, group formations, fast hand & foot movements
- **Ethnic groups associated:** Kaivartas, Deuris, Sonowal Kacharis, Chutiyas, Boros, Misings, Rabhas, Morans, Barahis

4. Ghoomar (गूमर)

- **Also called:** Gangaur
- **State:** Rajasthan
- **Origin:** Bhil tribe — performed to worship Goddess Saraswati; later adopted by other Rajasthani communities
- **Performers:** Women only (veiled/ghunghat, wearing ghaghra)
- **History:** Originally local women of Rajputana → later adopted by Rajput noble women; men were **not allowed to watch**

- **Popularized:** During Rajput kings' reign
- **Occasion:** Auspicious occasions
- **Regional variations:**
 - Gujarat border districts: **Fast tempo**, Garba-like steps
 - Dholpuri / Braj region: **Slow tempo**
 - Udaipur, Kota, Bundi: Variations in costume & style

5. Dollu Kunitha (ದೊಲ್ಲು ಕುನಿಠಾ)

- **State:** Karnataka
- **Energetic drum dance** — performed during major festivals & celebrations
- **Deity:** Sri Sri Veeralingeswara (form of Lord Shiva); dollu (drum) associated with Shiva
- **Legend:** Shiva made a drum from skins of slain demons; Kuruba Gowda community celebrates by drumming
- **Origin:** Kuruba Gowda community rituals, North Karnataka
- **Performance:** 10–12 drummers; both men & women; circular or semi-circular formation
- **Events:** Karga festival, temple processions, Mysuru Dasara, Jamboo Savari, Bengaluru Habba, temple car festivals

6. Kolattam (கலத்தம்)

- **States:** Tamil Nadu & Andhra Pradesh
- **Also called:** Kolannal, Kol Kolannal
- **Etymology:** "Kol" = small stick, "Attam" = play/dance
- **Antiquity:** Mentioned in Kanchipuram as "Chay Vak Aa Kol Attam"
- **Legend:** Demon Basavasura was enchanted by young girls performing Kolattam with sticks; event commemorated as **Kola Jathara** festival
- **Performers:** Only women
- **Group size:** 8 to 40 dancers
- **Pinal Kolattam:** Variation using **ropes** instead of sticks (colorful, visually striking)
- **Duration:** 10 days, starting after Diwali on Amavasya (new moon) night
- **Also performed** in other Indian states under different names

7. Padayani (പാദയാനി)

- **State:** Kerala
- **Location:** Bhadrakali temples on banks of Pampa River
- **Type:** Ritualistic art form
- **Legend:** After killing demon Daraka, Goddess Bhadrakali's rage wouldn't subside; Shiva's servants (Bhuta Ganas) danced before her to calm her down
- **Masks (Kolam):** Made from areca nut palm leaves (Erik Nat); entirely natural colors — green (wood), kari (black), manjal (yellow), podi, sindoor
- **Performance locations:** Kadammanitta, Kottangal, Thara, Kunnam, Thanam, many South Kerala temples
- **Kolam types:** Ganapati, Yakshi, Pakshi, Madan, Kalan, Murdha, Pishacha, Bhairavi, Gandharva, Mukalam
- **Community activity:** Villagers participate in collecting areca leaves & making kolams
- **Educates:** About historical, cultural, and ancient events of the region

8. Pata Kunitha (പാതാ കുന്തിത)

- **State:** Karnataka (Mysore region)
- **Performers:** Mainly men
- **Type:** Devotional dance; religious significance; focus on rhythm & talent, minimal commentary
- **Group size:** 10–15 people
- **Props:** Long bamboo poles called "**Pata**" (10–15 ft long), decorated with colorful ribbons, silver/brass umbrellas
- **Visual:** Unique, vibrant, energetic spectacle
- **Appeal:** Popular across all religions

Quick Reference Table

Dance	State	Performers	Key Feature	UNESCO
Chhau	Odisha, Jharkhand, WB	Men	Martial arts + dance, masks (exc. Mayurbhanj)	Yes (2010)
Kalbelia	Rajasthan	Women only	Serpent-like movements, spinning	Yes
Bihu	Assam	Both	3 seasonal types (Rongali/Kongali/Bhogali)	—
Ghoomar	Rajasthan	Women only	Veiled women, spinning, Rajput tradition	—
Dollu Kunittha	Karnataka	Both	Drum dance, Shiva	—
Kolattam	TN, AP	Women only	Stick/rope dance, 10-day festival	—
Padayani	Kerala	—	Ritualistic, areca palm masks (Kolam)	—
Pata Kunittha	Karnataka	Mainly men	Long bamboo poles, devotional	—

Indian Theatre

Dance is one component of India's broader theatrical tradition. From Sanskrit drama to regional folk theatre, Indian theatre has been a vehicle for entertainment and social commentary.

What is Theatre

- Composition of multiple skills: dance, acting, singing, talking, mime + theatre crafts (masks, makeup, costumes)
- Collective expression for entertainment & social education
- Commonly called **Drama**

1. CLASSICAL SANSKRIT THEATRE

Origins & Treatises

- Oldest amphitheatres: **Sita Bena & Jogi Mara caves** (excavated ruins)
- **Natya Shastra** by **Bharat Muni** (~2nd century AD) — first formal treatise on dramaturgy
- Legend: Lord Brahma created **Natya Veda** by combining elements of the 4 Vedas
- Natya Shastra describes **10 types of plays** (1-act to 10-acts)

Types of Ancient Plays

Type	Description
Lok Dharmi	Realistic depiction of people's lives
Natya Dharmi	Conventional plays using narration, style, symbolism

10 Play Categories (Rupakas)

Ank, Bhan, Dima, Tham, Gran, Natak, Prahasana, Prakaran, Svak, Vidi, Vyayog
(Only Natak & Prakaran detailed in Natya Shastra)

Conventions of Classical Sanskrit Plays

- Mostly 4–7 acts
- Always **happy ending** (tragedy extremely rare)
- Male protagonist always achieves his goal
- Well-defined: opening → progression → development → pause → conclusion

Key Playwrights & Plays

Playwright	Period	Notable Work(s)
Ashwaghosha	—	Sariputra Prakarana (9-act; first known classical Sanskrit drama)
Bhasa	4th–5th cent. BC	13 plays composed
Shudraka	—	Mrichchhakatika (The Little Clay Cart)
Vishakhadatta	—	Mudra Rakshasa
Bhavabhuti	—	Mahavir Charitra
Harshavardhana	—	Ratnavali
Kalidasa	—	Malavika Agnimitra , Vikramorvashi , Abhigyan Shakuntalam

Decline of Sanskrit Theatre

- Diversion toward poetry
- Rigidity → restricted creative space
- Declining popularity of Sanskrit
- Muslim ruler invasions

Surviving Classical Form

- **Koodiyattam / Koothiyattam** (Kerala) — follows all Natya Shastra rules
- Performed by **Chakyar** & **Nambiyar** castes
- Languages: Sanskrit, Prakrit, Malayalam
- Background music: **Maddalam** & **Edakka**
- Leading exponent: **Margi Madhu Chakyar**

2. FOLK THEATRE

- Rich tradition across India's regions
- Depicts local lifestyle, social norms, beliefs, customs
- Rural roots, rustic flavor

- Most forms emerged **15th-16th cent. AD** with devotional themes
- Later adapted love ballads & local hero stories

Three Sub-Types:

- A. Ritual Theatre
- B. Theatre of Entertainment
- C. South Indian Theatre

A. RITUAL THEATRE

Popular during **Bhakti movement** — expression of faith in God.

Form	State/Region	Key Details
Ankiya Nat	Assam	Mythological one-act play; started by Shankar Deva & disciple Mahadeva (16th cent. AD); opera-style; Krishna's life; Sutradhara + Gayan Bayan Mandali (musicians with Khol & cymbals); uses masks for expressions
Kala	Assam	Vaishnavite; branches: Dashavatar Kala , Gopal Kala , Galan Kala
Ramlila	Uttar Pradesh	Enacts Ramayana; performed before Dussehra ; male actors only (incl. female roles)
Raslila	Gujarat	Dance-drama on Radha-Krishna love story
Bhuta	Kerala (Kannara dist.)	"Spirit" — traditional practice of appeasing dead ancestors
Ramman	Uttarakhand (Garhwal)	Ritual theatre; villagers offer to Bhumiya Devta in temple courtyard; UNESCO Intangible Cultural Heritage ; key aspect: Jagar singing (musical rendition of local legends)

B. THEATRE OF ENTERTAINMENT

Secular stories of love, valor, socio-cultural themes. Aim: entertain rural masses.

Form	State/Region	Key Details
Bhavai	Rajasthan & Gujarat	Semi-classical music; instruments: Bhungala , Jhanjha , Tabla ; Sutradhara called Nayak
Das Kathiyai	Karnataka	Two narrators: Gayak (main singer) + Palia (co-narrator); wooden instrument = Kathiya
Garodia	Gujarat (Garodia community)	Uses painted pictures to narrate romance & valor
Jatra	Eastern India (Bengal)	Open-air; initiated by Vaishnavaites to spread Krishna's teachings
Karala	Himachal Pradesh (foothills)	Open-air theatre form
Maanch	MP (Malwa region)	Dialogues in couplets = Rangat Dohas
Swang	Punjab & Haryana	Music drama; instruments: Ek Tara , Harmonium , Sarangi , Dholak , Kharta
Nautanki	North India	Offshoot of Swang; most popular North Indian theatre ; historical/social/traditional stories; dialogues lyrical with Nagada drum beats
Ojapali	Assam	Associated with Manasa (serpent goddess) festival; 3 parts: Baniya Khand , Bhatiyali Khand , Dev Khand ; Oja = narrator, Paliz = chorus
Powada	Maharashtra	Folk play on Shivaji Maharaj killing Afzal Khan ; sung by Gondhali & Heers musicians
Tamasha	Maharashtra	Female-performed on Lavani songs
Villu Pattu	Deccan	Musical theatre; bow-shaped instruments ; narrates Ramayana
Bhand Pather	Jammu & Kashmir	Performed by Muslims; music + drama + dance
Bhaona	Assam (Majuli Island)	Promotes religion & moral teachings via entertainment
Dashavatar		Depicts Vishnu's 10 avatars

Form	State/Region	Key Details
	Konkan (Sindhudurg-Maharashtra, North Goa)	

C. SOUTH INDIAN THEATRE

Emphasis on dance (vs. North India's emphasis on music).

Form	State/Region	Key Details
Yakshagana	Karnataka	Originated in Vijayanagar Empire royal courts; performed by Jakkula Varun community
Burrakatha	Andhra Pradesh (Krishna dist.)	Dance-drama; name from Burra (pumpkin instrument)
Bayalata	Karnataka	Open-air; performed during local deity worship; stories of Radha-Krishna; 5 types : Dasartha, Sannata, Dodi Data, Parijata, Yakshagana; last two directed by single Sutradhara; others by 3-4 chorus + Vidushaka (clown)
Tal Maddale	Kerala & coastal Karnataka	Tal = cymbal, Maddale = drum; narration by Bhagavata with Arthadhari ; performed sitting (no dance/costumes/acting); open-air in temples; honors ancestor spirits; similar to Karnataka's Bhuta festival; mentioned in Sangam literature
Krishnattam	Kerala	8-day carnival festival; each night narrates Krishna's life story
Kurvanji	Tamil Nadu	Performed with classical Tamil poetry & songs
Theyyam	Kerala	Regional ritual performance

Key Terminology

Term	Meaning
Sutradhara	Narrator / stage director
Nayak	Sutradhara in Bhavai theatre
Vidushaka	Clown / jester
Bhagavata	Narrator in Tal Maddale
Arthadhari	Assistant narrator in Tal Maddale
Gayan Bayan Mandali	Musician group in Ankiya Nat
Rangat Dohas	Couplet-form dialogues in Maanch
Jagar	Musical rendition of local legends (Ramman)
Lavani	Song form used in Tamasha

Indian Puppetry

The theatrical impulse extends beyond human performers to puppetry — an ancient art where colourful puppets enact stories under the hands of a skilled Sutradhar.

What is Puppetry?

- **Puppetry (पुपेट्री)** = Folk art where puppets enact stories as a play
- Puppets are colorful, beautifully decorated dolls managed by a **Sutradhar** (string-holder)
- Entertains while showcasing culture & childhood nostalgia

Origin & History

- Practiced for **thousands of years** in India
- **Harappa & Mohenjo-daro** excavation sites yielded thread-connected puppets → evidence of puppetry in Indus Valley Civilization
- **Tamil classical literature Shilappadikaram** (1st-2nd BC) mentions puppets

- **Philosophical significance in Bhagavad Gita:** Krishna as Sutradhar (puppeteer), humans as puppets; Krishna called **Sutradhar**
- The puppet handler is also called **Sutradhar** — connecting Mahabharata era to modern tradition

Four Broad Categories of Indian Puppetry

1. STRING PUPPETS

Feature	Details
Material	Wood
Height	8-9 inches
Coloring	Oil paint
Body	Thin wooden pipes for limbs
Attire	Traditional Indian outfits
Accessories	Jewelry, ornaments for realistic look
Control	Strings attached → Sutradhar holds & moves them

Types of String Puppets

a) Kathputli — Rajasthan

- **Kath** (wood) + **Putli** (doll) = wooden doll
- **No legs** → strings attached to hands only
- Dressed in bright Rajasthani outfits + heavy jewelry
- Performed on **Rajasthani folk music**

b) Kundhei — Odisha

- Made of **light wood**
- Wears **long skirts**
- **Highly flexible** — more joints than other string puppets
- Light wood + multiple joints = easier, more efficient performance
- Shows influence of **Odissi dance**

c) Gombe Aata — Karnataka

- Ancient folk art of Karnataka
- Styling & design based on **Yakshagana** theatre/dance form
- Facial features & outfits recreated like Yakshagana dancers
- Heavy costumes + typical dance moves → **needs multiple Sutradhars** to control

d) Bommalattam — Tamil Nadu

- **Tallest & heaviest** puppets in India
- Height: **4-5 feet**; Weight: **~10 kg**
- Strings attached to an **iron ring**
- Sutradhar **wears the iron ring on his head** to control the puppet
- Iron rods + strings = easier movement

2. SHADOW PUPPETS

Feature	Details
Material	Leather (not metal or wood)
Shape	Flat figures, cut into puppet shapes
Painting	Painted identically on both sides
Decoration	Not decorated further
Performance	Placed on white screen , light from behind → shadow visible to audience
Control	Sutradhar moves puppets during performance

Types of Shadow Puppets

a) Galu Gombe Aata — Karnataka

- Most popular shadow theatre of Karnataka
- **Unique feature**: Puppet size = **social status**
- Kings, rulers, religious figures → **large puppets**
- Common citizens → **small puppets**
- Size variation helps audience identify characters

b) Ravana Chhaya — Odisha

- Puppets made from **deer skin**
- **Bold decoration** style
- **Dramatic poses**
- Includes **non-human figures** (animals, birds, trees) + human figures
- **Vocal artists** provide lyrical & musical narrative
- Adds depth to the performance

c) Tholu Bommalata — Andhra Pradesh

- **Grand-scale** puppet construction
- Painted **colorfully on both sides**
- Uses **classical music**
- Depicts **mythological stories** (religious significance)
- Key source of Andhra's culture & civilization

3. GLOVE PUPPETS

Feature	Details
Also called	Sleeve Puppets, Hand Puppets, Palm Puppets
Size	Very small
Construction	Only head + long sleeve/skirt (no full body)
Materials	Cloth, paper, or wood
Control	Sutradhar wears puppet like a glove on both arms
Head movement	Index finger inside the head
Expressions	Other fingers create facial expressions & dance
Appeal	Lifelike performance; highly popular across India

Types of Glove Puppets

a) Pava Kathu — Kerala

- Traditional glove puppet show of Kerala
- Originated around **18th century**
- Decorated with **colorful paints, feathers, jewelry**
- Shows influence of **Kathakali** folk dance (similar ornamentation)
- Enacts mythological stories — **Mahabharata & Ramayana**

4. ROD PUPPETS

Feature	Details
Control	Rods from behind the screen (no strings, no shadows, no gloves)
Construction	Similar to string puppets but joined to metallic rods instead of strings
Effect	Equally captivating as other forms

Types of Rod Puppets

a) Yampuri — Bihar

- Integral part of Bihar's folk art
- Made of **wood** with **no joints**
- Painted & decorated with colorful costumes
- Rods attached for performance

b) Putul Naach — West Bengal

- Similar rod puppet tradition (transcript cuts off)

History of Coins and Currency in India

From performing arts, we shift to the material history of trade — the evolution of coins and currency in India, from barter through punch-marked coins to digital currency.

Foundations

- **Money** = common medium of exchange for goods & services
- **Currency** = money issued by a central government (India → Rupees, USA → Dollars)
- Forms of currency: Coins → Paper Currency → Digital Currency → Crypto Currency

Pre-Currency: Barter System

- Goods exchanged directly for goods (e.g., food grains for cloth)
- Problems: double coincidence of wants, no standard valuation, time/effort heavy
- Barter used in **Prehistoric Age** (Paleolithic, Mesolithic, Neolithic) — no currency evidence; society was hunting-gathering, limited exchange

Indus Valley / Harappan Civilization (3500-1300 BC)

- First evidence of currency-like system in India
- Long-distance trade with **Mesopotamian Civilization** (present-day Iraq)
- No coins recovered — speculated use of **stone seals** for trading
- Harappan seals found in Iraq/Syria region
- Harappan coins question **still unresolved** until script is deciphered
- Some historians believe barter was used, but barter for long-distance trade seems impractical

Vedic Age (1500-600 BC)

- No conclusive evidence of coins/currency
- **Rigvedic people**: pastoral, dependent on animals & animal products
- **Later Vedic people**: agriculturalists
- Trade limited and mostly in **barter form**

Mahajanapada Period (circa 600 BC) — Punch-Marked Coins

- First conclusive evidence of currency use in India
- **16 Mahajanapadas** ruling (Magadha, Kashi, Avanti, Vajji key ones)
- **Buddhist texts** and **Panini's Ashtadhyayi** mention copper & silver coins
- Called **Karshapana** or **Pana**
- Irregular shape; symbols punched onto them → **Punch-Marked Coins**
- Symbols varied by Mahajanapada:

- Saurashtra → **bull** symbol
- Panchala → **swastika** symbol

Mauryan Empire — Punch-Marked Coins Peak

- First all-India empire → trade & economic activity boomed
- Common currency essential; massive issuance of punch-marked coins
- Used ~450 different symbols:
 - **Natural symbols**: sun, moon, hills, trees
 - **Geometric figures**: circle, rectangle, wheel
 - **Human figures & animals**

Indo-Greeks — Die-Struck Coins & Portraits

- First to issue **die-struck coins** in India (molds used in mints → uniform shape)
- **Mint** = place where metals melted & shaped into coins
- First to use **portraits** on coins
- e.g., King **Menander** shown at various life stages

Kushana Dynasty (1st-4th Century AD) — Gold Coins

- Ruled North India
- First to issue **large quantities of gold coins**
- Coin features:
 - **Obverse**: King's portrait, name, title
 - **Reverse**: King's favorite deity/god
- Used **Brahmi** language on coins

Gupta Empire — Sanskrit on Coins & Dinara

- First to use **Sanskrit** on coins
- Issued abundant **gold coins** called **Dinara**
- Some kings showed artistic side: **Samudragupta** & **Kumaragupta** depicted playing **veena**

Delhi Sultanate (till end of 12th Century AD)

- Coins inspired by **Islamic history & culture**

- Turkish rulers replaced royal Indian designs with **Islamic calligraphy**
- Islamic culture prohibited human figures/portraits on coins
- Metals used: **Gold, Silver, Copper**
- **Higher value coin: Tanka**
- **Lower value coin: Jittal**

Sher Shah Suri (1540-1555) — Tri-Metallic System

- Ruled only 15 years but introduced landmark currency reform
- **Tri-Metallic System** standardised: | Metal | Coin Name | Standard Weight |
|-----|-----|-----| | Gold | **Mohar** | 169 grams | | Silver | **Rupee (Rupaya)**
| 178 grams | | Copper | **Dam** | — |
- 1 Silver Rupee = **40 Copper Dam**
- Sher Shah's **Rupee** format continued till early 20th century — **precursor to modern Rupee**

Mughal Empire (from 1526)

- Unified & standardised currency system — **copied Sher Shah Suri's tri-metallic system**
- Continued Mohar, Rupee, Dam structure

British Rule & Independent India

- **1717**: British got permission from Mughal ruler **Farrukhsiyar** to mint Mughal coins
- Gold coin → **Carolina**
- Silver coin → **Angelina**
- Copper coin → **Cupperoon**
- After **Battle of Plassey (1757)** & **Battle of Buxar (1764)**, British became de facto rulers
- Still used Mughal money but no longer needed Mughal permission to mint
- **Post-1857 Revolt**: Rupee declared official currency; Mughal calligraphy replaced with portrait of **King George V**
- **1935**: **Reserve Bank of India (RBI)** established to manage currency

Post-Independence Currency Reforms

- **15 August 1950: Anna System** introduced — first indigenous coinage system of independent India
- 1 Rupee = **16 Annas**
- British king portrait removed → replaced by **Ashoka's Lion Capital**
- **1956 (Coinage Amendment Act): Decimal Coin System** introduced
- 1 Rupee = **100 Paise**
- Old Anna System → **Purana Rupee** (old rupee)
- New Decimal System → **Naya Rupee** (new rupee)

Paper Currency in India

- First paper currency issued by British Government in **1861**
- Denominations: ₹10, ₹20, ₹50, ₹100, ₹500, ₹2000
- Advantages: easy to carry, low issuance cost
- Higher denominations → paper currency
- Lower denominations (₹1, ₹2, ₹5, ₹10) → coins

Digital & Crypto Currency

- **21st Century**: Digital India age
- Money transferred digitally via mobile & internet
- Digital wallets functionally similar to physical wallets but enable easy long-distance transfer
- **Cryptocurrency**: decentralized (no central government issuance)
- Created by programmers solving complex calculations ("mining")
- Supporters claim it will reform global currency system & prevent government manipulation
- Rapid adoption in India

Calendars of India

Just as currency organised economic life, calendars organised time itself. India developed multiple calendar systems reflecting its rich astronomical tradition.

Why Calendars Were Invented

- Settled life (post hunting-gathering) created need for **timekeeping**
- Required for: trade, festivals, religious gatherings, administration
- Calendar = solution to record days, months, years
- Calendar development in India was **linked to astronomy**

History of Calendar-Making in India

- **Vedic Age** – origin point. **Jyotisha** (one of the six Vedangas) studied positions of Sun, Moon, Earth, constellations to determine time
- Purpose: find **auspicious (shubh)** positions of celestial bodies for Vedic rituals
- **Aryabhata** in Aryabhatiya calculated solar year as: **365 days, 6 hours, 12 minutes, 3.84 seconds**
- Modern scientific value: **365 days, 5 hours, 59 minutes, 16 seconds** – remarkably close
- By **Medieval Age**: **~30 different calendars** existed across India, varying by region, history, culture

Three Methods to Define a Year

System	Basis	Duration	Notes
Solar Year	Earth's revolution around Sun	365 d 5 h 5 min 16 s	Calendar year = 365 days; leftover time added via different methods per calendar
Lunar Year	Moon's revolution around Earth	354 days (29.5 × 12)	11 days shorter than solar year
Luni-Solar Year	Year = solar cycle, months = moon cycle	Combination	Best of both

- **Adhika Maas** (extra month) added every **2.5 years** to sync lunar calendar with solar cycle → keeps seasons & festivals fixed

Common Features Across Indian Calendars

- Month names are **similar**: Chaitra, Vaishakha, Jyeshtha, Ashadha, Shravana, Bhadrapada, Ashwina, Kartika, Margashirsha, Pausha, Magha, Phalguna
- Regional variations exist: e.g. Vaishakha = **Bohag** (Assamese) / **Bośāk** (Bengali)

1. Vikram Calendar (Vikram Samvat / Vikram Era)

Property	Detail
Start Year	56 BC (56 years before Christian era)
Founder	King Vikramaditya of Ujjain (after victory over Shaka dynasty)
Followers	Hindus in India & Nepal; Hindu festival dates based on this
Type	Lunar calendar
Year length	354 days, 12 months
New Year	Chaitra month, day after Amavasya (new moon) → March/April (Gregorian)
Alternate NY	Some regions celebrate Kartik 1 (October) as New Year

Month Division

- Each month → **2 fortnights (pakshas)**:
- **Shukla Paksha** (Bright half): starts day after Amavasya, ends on Purnima (full moon)
- **Krishna Paksha** (Dark half): starts day after Purnima, ends on Amavasya
- **New month starts from Krishna Paksha**
- **Adhika Maas** added every 2.5 years to sync with solar cycle

12 Months of Vikram Calendar

Chaitra → Vaishakha → Jyeshtha → Ashadha → Shravana → Bhadrapada → Ashwina → Kartika → Margashirsha → Pausha → Magha → Phalguna

2. Saka Calendar (Saka Era)

Property	Detail
Start Year	78 AD
Founder	King Shalivahana (belonged to Saka tribe)
Type	Luni-solar calendar
Year length	365 days, 12 months (366 in leap year)
Leap year	Every 4 years
Start date	Generally 22 March (23 March in leap year)
Months	Same names as Vikram calendar
Status	National Calendar of India (declared 1957)

Key Point

- Government of India uses **Saka date alongside Gregorian date** in all official notifications & communications

3. Hijri Calendar (Islamic Calendar)

Property	Detail
Origin	Arabia
Original name	Amul Fil; renamed after Prophet Muhammad's death
Era name	Hijri (from Hijrat – Prophet's migration from Mecca to Medina)
Zero year	622 AD (migration event)
Type	Purely lunar (no intercalation)
Year length	354 days , 12 months (~29.5 days/month)
Followers	Muslims worldwide

Critical Difference

- Does **NOT** add extra month → **no reconciliation with solar year**
- Consequence 1: Each Hijri year falls **~11 days behind** Gregorian calendar
 - e.g. If Gregorian = 2030, Hijri $\approx$ 2029
- Consequence 2: **Seasons & festivals drift** – Ramadan may shift from summer to winter over decades

12 Months of Hijri Calendar

1. Muharram (1st month)
2. Safar
3. Rabi' al-awwal
4. Rabi' al-thani
5. Jumada al-awwal
6. Jumada al-thani
7. Rajab
8. Sha'ban
9. Ramadan
10. Shawwal
11. Dhu al-Qa'dah
12. Dhu al-Hijjah (last month)

4. Gregorian Calendar

- Mentioned as commonly used alongside Saka calendar in official Indian government communications
- (Transcript cut off — full details not available)

Quick Comparison Table

Feature	Vikram	Saka	Hijri	Gregorian
Era start	56 BC	78 AD	622 AD	—
Type	Lunar	Luni-solar	Lunar	Solar
Year length	354 d	365 d	354 d	365/366 d
Extra month?	Yes (Adhika Maas)	Yes (leap day)	No	Yes (leap day)
Seasons fixed?	Yes	Yes	No (drifts)	Yes
Used by	Hindus (India/ Nepal)	National (Govt of India)	Muslims	Global standard

Indian Literature - Ancient Period

India's literary tradition is one of the world's oldest, beginning with the Vedas and flowing through epics, philosophy, and classical drama.

INTRODUCTION

- Literature = mirror of society; reflects conditions, helps understand past & ancestors' perspectives
- Indian literary tradition = one of world's oldest
- Oldest surviving text = **Vedas** (Sanskrit); foundation stone of Sanatan Dharma & Indian civilization
- Non-religious literature also flourished (Kalidasa's dramas & poetry)
- Literary history = unbroken chain connecting past to present

LANGUAGES FOCUSED

- **Sanskrit, Pali, Prakrit, Dravidian languages**
- **Sanskrit**: world's oldest surviving languages; developed from ~1500 BC (Vedic Age)
- Sanskrit = Mother of all Indo-Aryan languages; influenced Prakrit, Pali, Dravidian, Hindi, Bengali, etc.

VEDAS

- **"Veda"** = knowledge; divine/eternal in Sanatan Dharma
- Not restricted to any sect/geography; treats universe as one family
- Chantings/prayers for peace, prosperity, health, happiness
- **Composed:** 3000 BC – 1000 BC; orally transmitted for generations
- **Written compilation:** ~600 BC
- **Four types:**

1. RIGVEDA

- Oldest Veda; **1028 individual Sanskrit hymns**
- Oldest surviving composition of any Indo-Aryan language
- Themes: life, death, creation, sacrifice
- **Chief deity:** Indra (Rain God) — most hymns dedicated to him
- Other gods: Agni (fire), Varuna (water), Rudra (wind & storm), Aditya (sun), Vayu (air), Ashwini Twins
- Female gods: Usha (dawn), Prithvi (earth), Vak (speech)
- Society was nature-worshipping

2. YAJURVEDA

- **"Yajur"** = sacrifice
- Mantras & rituals for sacrifices
- Called **"Ritual Veda"** — guidebook for priests/rishis conducting sacrifices

3. SAMAVEDA

- **"Sama"** = melody/songs
- **1875 hymns** arranged as musical ragas & raginis
- Called **"Book of Chants"**
- Proof that Indian music developed in the Vedic Age

4. ATHARVAVEDA

- Also called **"Brahma Veda"**
- Credited to rishis **Atharva & Angira**
- Focus: daily life peace & prosperity + treatment for **999 diseases** (via mantras & kriyas)

- Sometimes called "book of black magic"

VEDANGAS (6 limbs/branches of Vedas)

1. **Shiksha** — education/phonetics
2. **Nirukta** — etymology
3. **Chhanda** — metrics/prosody
4. **Jyotisha** — astronomy
5. **Vyakarana** — grammar
6. **(also Shiksha listed earlier)**
7. **Panini's Ashtadhyayi** (~400 BC) = best Vedanga example; defines Sanskrit grammar rules

BRAHMANAS & ARANYAKAS (Vedic commentaries)

- Provide detailed explanation of Vedic mantras
- **Brahmanas**: Vedic rituals & sacrifices detail
- **Aranyakas**: abstract topics — soul, birth, death, beyond
- Final part of Aranyakas = **Upanishads**

UPANISHADS

- **"Upa-ni-shad"** = sitting near the guru (represents Guru-Shishya parampara)
- Last part of Vedas → called **"Vedanta"**
- Philosophical questions: life, death, salvation
- ~200 written; **108 popular**
- Focus: right knowledge & beliefs (NOT rituals)
- **Popular Upanishads**: Kathopanishad, Mundaka Upanishad, Shwetashwatara Upanishad
- **"Satyameva Jayate"** (Truth Alone Triumphs) — from Upanishads, inscribed in India's national emblem

PURANAS

- Ancient Indian mythological texts
- Stories: universe formation to destruction
- Main focus: **Hindu Trinity** — Brahma, Vishnu, Mahesh (Shiva)

- **18 Puranas** — each tells story of an important god; explains philosophical/religious concepts
- Written in simple language/story format → more popular among common people than Vedas
- Gave rise to **Upapuranas** (minor Puranas)

RAMAYANA

- Multiple versions; most popular = **Valmiki's Ramayana**
- **"Adi Kavya"** (earliest epic); Valmiki = **"Adi Kavi"** (earliest poet)
- **24,000 verses**; divided into **7 Kandas (parts)**
- Each Kanda depicts important events from Lord Ram & Sita's life
- **Yuddha Kanda**: Ram's victory over demon king Ravana; Sita rescued from Lanka
- Represents triumph of good over evil
- Through Ram's life (Maryada Purushottam), teaches **4 Purusharthas**: Dharma, Artha, Kama, Moksha

MAHABHARATA

- Most popular version = **Vedavyasa's**
- Originally **8,800 verses** → called **"Jaya"**
- Expanded to **24,000 verses** → called **"Bharata"** (after ancient Vedic tribe Bharat)
- Current form: **1 lakh (100,000) verses** → **"Mahabharata"**
- Conflict: **Kauravas vs Pandavas**
- Main narrator: **Shri Krishna** (avatar of Vishnu)
- Contains **Bhagavad Gita**: Krishna's message to Arjuna before war
- Topics: Dharma, Karma, righteous living
- Explained for society's benefit

NON-RELIGIOUS SANSKRIT LITERATURE

DRAMA

- **Popular playwrights**: Kalidasa, Sudraka, Vaishakh Datta, Bhavabhuti, Bhasa
- **Kalidasa's Abhijnana Shakuntalam** (Recognition of Shakuntala) — most popular Sanskrit drama

- Story: King Dushyanta & Shakuntala → meet in forest, separated, reunited via son **Bharat**
- King Bharat → founded **Bharat Dynasty** → descendants = **Bharatvanshi**
- India's Hindi name "**Bharat**" derives from King Bharat
- **Vikramorvasiyam** (Urvashi)
- **Malavikagnimitram** (love story of Malavika & Agnimitra)

POETRY (Kalidasa)

- Kumarasambhava, Raghuvansha, Meghadootam, Ritusambhara

OTHER POETS

- **Hari Sen**: poems on Samudragupta's bravery; included in Allahabad Pillar Inscription

BOOKS OF LAW (500 BC - 200 BC)

- **Dharma Sutras & Dharma Shastras**: rules governing Hindu society
- Property transfer, punishments for crimes
- **Manusmriti**: describes roles of men & women; supports caste-based society with different punishments for different castes

OTHER KEY WORKS

- **Kautilya's Arthashastra**: economics, diplomacy, statecraft

PALI & PRAKRIT LITERATURE (Post-Vedic Age)

- Buddhists & Jains made these languages prominent → became languages of common people
- **Buddha gave sermons in Pali**

BUDDHIST LITERATURE

- **Tripitakas** (in Pali):
- **Vinaya Pitaka** — daily life rules & regulations for monks
- **Sutta Pitaka** — morality & Dhamma (dharma)
- **Abhidhamma Pitaka** — philosophy & physics

- **Jataka Stories**: compilation of Buddha's **previous 550 births**
- Uses popular myths, folklore, moral stories
- Message of righteous living

JAIN LITERATURE

- Jain Tirthankars used **Prakrit** to spread philosophy
- **Anga, Upanga, Parikrama** — most popular Jain texts in Prakrit

DRAVIDIAN LITERATURE

- Four major Dravidian languages: **Tamil, Telugu, Malayalam, Kannada**
- **Tamil**: oldest; closest to Sanskrit in grammar & root words

TAMIL LITERATURE

- **Sangam Literature** (300 BC – 300 AD)
- ~**2381 poems** by **473 poets**
- "Sangam" = assemblies organized by **Pandya kings in Madurai**
- Two fields:
 - **Akam** (inner): love, sexual relationships, abstract emotions
 - **Puram** (outer): social life, ethics, valour, customs
- **Tiruvalluvar's Thirukkural (Kural)**
- Topics: politics, governance, love, morality
- Called "**Tamil Vedas**"
- **Two major Tamil epics**:
- **Silappadikaram** (Story of an Anklet) — by **Ilango Adigal**
- **Manimekalai** — by **Shattan**
- **Bhakti movement (9th-12th century)**:
- **Alvars**: Vishnu worshippers — devotional poetry in Tamil
- **Nayanars**: Shiva worshippers — devotional poetry in Tamil

MALAYALAM LITERATURE

- Spoken in Kerala & adjoining areas; youngest Dravidian language
- **Origin**: 11th century; developed rich corpus in 400 years
- Major works: **Bhasha Kautilya** (commentary on Arthashastra), **Kokasandesha**

TELUGU LITERATURE

- Development ~10th–11th century
- **Vijayanagar period = Golden Age of Telugu literature**
- **Nachana Somana** (court poet of Bukka I): **Uttara Harivamsha**
- **Krishna Deva Raya**: accomplished poet & writer; composed **Amuktamalyada** (16th century)
- **Ashtadiggajas** — 8 distinguished scholars attached to Vijayanagar court; produced exceptional Telugu compositions

Indian Literature — Medieval & Modern Period (11th Century Onwards)

The ancient literary tradition gave way to new currents from the 11th century — Persian and Urdu influences, Bhakti poetry in regional languages, and the transformative impact of the printing press.

Big Picture Trends (Post-10th Century)

- **Two new trends from 11th century** shaped Indian literature:
- Turk & Mongol settlement → cultural/linguistic influence (Persian, Urdu)
- Bhakti & Sufi movements → rise of regional languages & devotional literature
- **British colonial period (18th–19th century)**: introduced modern printing press; Europeans translated Indian works into European languages (e.g. Charles Wilkins translated Bhagavad Gita into English, 1785)
- **Printing press** made literature accessible to the masses → **nationalist leaders** used literature to spread nationalism & fight British rule

1. Persian Literature

- Persian & Sanskrit both evolved from a common **Indo-European** language
- **Introduced by Turks & Mongols** in 12th century AD
- **Court language** of Delhi Sultanate & Mughals
- **Amir Khusro** (1253–1325) — earliest Persian poets in India; disciple of Nizamuddin Auliya
- Poetry collection: **Diwan**

- Works: Nuh Siphir, Masnavi Deval Rani Khizr Khan (Alauddin Khilji's son + Rajput princess Deval Rani)
- **Sultanate Historians:**
- **Ziauddin Barani:** Tarikh-i-Firoz Shahi (history till Firoz Shah Tughlaq), Fatwa-i-Jahandari (political values for Muslim rulers)
- **Minhaj-us-Siraj**
- **Mughal Period (zenith of Persian):**
- **Babur:** Tuzuk-i-Baburi (autobiography in Turkish; translated to Persian by Akbar)
- **Gulbadan Banu Begum** (Humayun's sister): Humayun Nama (Humayun's struggles to recapture throne)
- **Abul Fazl** (Akbar's court historian): Ain-i-Akbari, Akbar Nama (key sources on Mughal society & polity)
- Akbar commissioned translation of Sanskrit works into Persian: Ramayana, Mahabharata (Persian trans. = **Razmnama**), Upanishads
- **Jahangir:** Tuzuk-i-Jahangiri (autobiography in Persian)
- Shah Jahan Nama, Alamgir Nama (describe Shah Jahan & Aurangzeb's reigns)
- **Decline after Aurangzeb's death (1707)** → Persian replaced by Urdu
- **Last Mughal ruler Bahadur Shah Zafar** — famous Urdu poet (pen name: **Zafar**)

2. Urdu Literature

- **Origin:** interaction of Turkish (Persian-speaking) soldiers & Indian (Hindi-speaking) soldiers in Sultanate army barracks
- **Grammar** follows Hindi; **script** follows Persian
- First adopted in **Deccan region** — Bahmani states (Ahmednagar, Golconda, Bijapur, Berar) → called **Dakkhani**
- **14th century:** Amir Khusro wrote in both Persian & Urdu
- **Golden period: 18th-19th century** — became common people's language
- Key poets: **Mirza Ghalib, Sauda, Dard, Mir Taqi Mir**
- **Sir Syed Ahmad Khan** (20th c.): reforms in Muslim society through Urdu literature
- **Mohammad Iqbal:** Bang-i-Dara (poetry collection); wrote Sare Jahan se Achha Hindustan Hamara
- **Premchand** wrote in Urdu before Hindi

3. Hindi Literature

- **Evolution:** Apabhramsha → Hindi (7th–14th century AD); Apabhramsha itself evolved from Prakrit
- **Bhakti Movement (from 11th c.)** → key driver of Hindi & other regional languages
- **Major Dialects:**
 - **Braj Bhasha** — Braj region, UP
 - **Awadhi** — Awadh region, UP
 - **Bhojpuri, Magadhi, Maithili** — Bihar
 - **Khari Boli** — Delhi & surroundings (most popular form; Urdu influence visible)
 - **Rajasthani** — Rajasthan (considered Hindi dialect)
- **Bhakti Poets & their languages:**
 - **Tulsidas** — Ramcharitmanas (Awadhi)
 - **Surdas & Bihari** — Braj Bhasha
 - **Mirabai** — Rajasthani
 - **Kabir** — multiple dialects (Awadhi, Braj, + Persian influence)
- **Nationalist period (British rule):** shift from devotional → nationalist themes; Sanskrit works translated to Hindi to reconnect with roots
- **Bharatendu Harishchandra** (19th c.): Andher Nagari (City of Darkness), Bharat Durdasha (called to overthrow British)
- **Swami Dayanand Saraswati:** Satyarth Prakash
- **Munshi Premchand** (Novel King/Upanyas Samrat): Godan, Gaban, Rangbhoomi
- **Other 20th c. writers:**
 - **Suryakant Tripathi Nirala**
 - **Maithili Sharan Gupt**
 - **Sumitranandan Pant**
 - **Ramdhari Singh Dinkar**
 - **Harivansh Rai Bachchan**
 - **Mahadevi Verma** — women's issues; awarded **Padma Vibhushan**

4. Bengali, Assamese & Odia Literature

Bengali

- Bhakti period → **Mangal Kavyas** (devotional works)
- Bengal = first Indian region under British

- **William Carey** established printing press at **Serampore (1800)**; published Bengali grammar & English-Bengali dictionary
- **Raja Ram Mohan Roy** (18th c.): Sambad Kaumudi (Bengali journal), Mirat-ul-Akhbar (Persian journal); campaigned against sati, polygamy, child marriage
- **Ishwar Chandra Vidyasagar** & **Akshay Kumar Datta** — contemporaries; social reform through literature
- **Bankim Chandra Chattopadhyay**: Anand Math (inspired by Sanyasi rebellion of late 18th c.); national song **Vande Mataram** from this novel
- **Rabindranath Tagore**: first Indian to win **Nobel Prize** (1913, Literature for Gitanjali)
- **20th c.**: Sarat Chandra Chatterjee, Kazi Nazrul Islam, R.C. Dutt

Assamese

- Medieval court chronicles = **Buranjis** (recorded Ahom kings' history)
- Bhakti saint **Shankardeva** → devotional poetry
- Modern: **Padmanath Gohain Baruah**, **Lakshminath Bezbaroa**

Odia

- Medieval: **Sarala Das**, **Upendra Bhanja**
- Modern: **Radhanath Ray**, **Fakir Mohan Senapati**

5. Gujarati Literature

- Earliest: **14th-15th c. Bhakti songs**
- **Narsingh Mehta**: fusion of folk lore + Krishna devotional songs
- **Narmad** (Narmadashankar Lalshankar Dave) — famous poet
- **Govardhanram Tripathi**: Saraswati Chandra (classic Gujarati novel)
- **Dr. K.M. Munshi**: Prithvi Vallabh (fiction + non-fiction)

6. Marathi Literature

- **Oldest**: 13th c. — Saint **Dnyaneshwar** (Jnanadeva): detailed commentary on Bhagavad Gita in Marathi
- Bhakti saints: **Namdev**, **Sena**, **Gora**
- **16th c. — Saint Eknath**: commentaries on Bhagavata Purana & Ramayana in Marathi; devotional poems still popular in Maharashtra

- **Tukaram & Ramdas** — other major Bhakti saints
- **Independence movement**: Marathi newspapers & pamphlets
- **Bal Gangadhar Tilak**: Kesari (Marathi newspaper against British policies)
- Other writers: **M.G. Ranade, G.T. Madhokar, K.T. Telang**

7. Punjabi Literature

- Influenced by **NW frontier geography** → Indian + Islamic influences
- Two scripts: **Gurmukhi & Persian**
- **Adi Granth Sahib** (Sikh holy book) — mostly Gurmukhi; includes couplets of Kabir, Nanak, Dadu (Hindi influence visible)
- Compiled by **Guru Arjan Dev Ji**
- **Guru Gobind Singh Ji** added remaining Gurus' hymns → became **Guru Granth Sahib**
- **Folk Love Stories/Poems**:
 - Sohni Mahiwal, Sassi Punnu
 - **Waris Shah**: Heer Ranjha
 - **Sufi Poets**: **Baba Farid, Bulleh Shah**; Sant Chola = classical example

8. Kannada Literature (Recap from Part 1)

- **Patronized by** Vijayanagara rulers & Jain scholars
- **Madhava**: Dharmanatha Purana (on 15 Jain Tirthankaras)
- **Urita Vilasa**: Dharma Pariksha (Jain teachings)
- **Three Gems of Kannada Literature** (10th c. AD):
 - **Pampa** — Father of Kannada Literature; Adi Purana, Vikramarjuna Vijaya
 - **Ponna**
 - **Ranna**
- Patronized by Chalukya & Rashtrakuta kings

Quick Reference — Authors & Key Works

Author	Language	Key Work(s)
Amir Khusro	Persian, Urdu	Diwan, Nuh Siphir, Masnavi Deval Rani Khizr Khan
Ziauddin Barani	Persian	Tarikh-i-Firoz Shahi, Fatwa-i-Jahandari
Abul Fazl	Persian	Ain-i-Akbari, Akbar Nama
Gulbadan Banu Begum	Persian	Humayun Nama
Babur	Turkish	Tuzuk-i-Baburi
Jahangir	Persian	Tuzuk-i-Jahangiri
Mirza Ghalib	Urdu	Poetry
Mir Taqi Mir	Urdu	Poetry
Mohammad Iqbal	Urdu	Bang-i-Dara
Tulsidas	Awadhi (Hindi)	Ramcharitmanas
Surdas	Braj Bhasha	Devotional poetry
Kabir	Mixed dialects	Dohas (couplets)
Mirabai	Rajasthani	Devotional poetry
Bharatendu Harishchandra	Hindi	Andher Nagari, Bharat Durdasha
Premchand	Hindi, Urdu	Godan, Gaban, Rangbhoomi
Mahadevi Verma	Hindi	Poetry on women's issues
Bankim Chandra Chattopadhyay	Bengali	Anand Math (source: Vande Mataram)
Rabindranath Tagore	Bengali	Gitanjali (Nobel 1913)
Raja Ram Mohan Roy	Bengali, Persian	Sambad Kaumudi, Mirat-ul-Akhbar
Kazi Nazrul Islam	Bengali	Poetry
Shankardeva	Assamese	Devotional poetry

Author	Language	Key Work(s)
Narsingh Mehta	Gujarati	Bhakti songs
Govardhanram Tripathi	Gujarati	Saraswati Chandra
K.M. Munshi	Gujarati	Prithvi Vallabh
Dnyaneshwar	Marathi	Commentary on Bhagavad Gita
Eknath	Marathi	Commentaries on Bhagavata Purana, Ramayana
Tukaram	Marathi	Devotional poetry
Bal Gangadhar Tilak	Marathi	Kesari (newspaper)
Waris Shah	Punjabi	Heer Ranjha
Baba Farid	Punjabi	Sufi poetry
Bulleh Shah	Punjabi	Sufi poetry
Pampa	Kannada	Adi Purana, Vikramarjuna Vijaya

Key Terms Glossary

Term	Meaning
Apabhramsha	Stage of Prakrit → gave birth to modern Indo-Aryan languages (Hindi, Bengali, Assamese, etc.)
Mangal Kavyas	Bengali devotional works from Bhakti period
Buranjis	Assamese court chronicles of Ahom kings
Razmnama	Persian translation of Mahabharata (commissioned by Akbar)
Dakkhani	Early name for Urdu in Deccan (Bahmani states)
Khari Boli	Most popular Hindi dialect (Delhi region; shows Urdu influence)
Diwan	Poetry collection (Persian/Urdu)
Gurmukhi	Script of Punjabi (associated with Sikh scripture)
Adi Granth / Guru Granth Sahib	Sikh holy scripture (compiled by Guru Arjan Dev; completed by Guru Gobind Singh)

Languages of India

The diversity of Indian literature is inseparable from the diversity of its languages — three major families, over 19,500 mother tongues, and 22 scheduled languages.

1. India's Language Diversity (Census 2011)

- **19,500** mother tongues; **121** major languages ($\geq 10,000$ speakers each)
- Hindi alone has **≥ 40 dialects/mother tongues**: Bhojpuri, Magahi, Braj Bhasha, Haryanvi, etc.
- Proverb: "Kos kos par badle paani, chaar kos par baani" — water changes every mile, language every few miles.

2. Three Major Language Families of India

Family	% of Population	Regions
Indo-Aryan	~74%	North, Central, West, East India
Dravidian	~25%	South India
Sino-Tibetan	~0.6%	North & Northeast frontiers

3. Indo-Aryan Family

Origin & Scope

- Subgroup of larger **Indo-European** family (spoken across Central Asia & Europe)
- Brought by **Aryans** migrating into India; evolved through local interaction
- Ancient: **Sanskrit, Prakrit, Pali** → Modern: **Hindi, Gujarati, Bengali, Marathi, Punjabi, Assamese, Rajasthani**, etc.

Sanskrit

- Developed from **Vedic Age (~1900 BC)** — oldest continuously developed Indian language
- **Vedas, Upanishads, Puranas, Dharmashastras** composed in Sanskrit
- **Panini's Ashtadhyayi (~400 BC)** — grammar rules still unchanged after 2000+ years
- **Golden Phase: Gupta Period** — Kalidasa (Abhijnana Shakuntalam, Meghadootam), Vishakhadatta, Shudraka
- Became **language of the educated elite** (Brahmins & Kings); declined among common people

Prakrit & Pali

- **Prakrit** (~600–1000 AD): Not a single language but a **group** of common people's languages in Mahajanapadas
- **Magadhi / Ardha-Magadhi**: Spoken in Magadha; **Mahavira's Jain texts** composed in it
- **Pali**: Derived from Prakrit; **Buddha's sermons** in Pali
- Three key Buddhist texts: **Vinaya Pitaka, Sutta Pitaka, Abhidhamma Pitaka**

- **Apabhramsha** (8th–9th C AD): Transitional dialects before modern Indo-Aryan languages; **Hindi & Bengali emerged from Apabhramsha**

Modern Indo-Aryan Languages (post-1000 AD)

- **Hindi, Assamese, Bengali, Gujarati, Marathi, Punjabi, Rajasthani**
- Hindi lexicon draws from **Sanskrit + Apabhramsha + English + Urdu**
- **~44%** of India's population speaks/understands Hindi today

4. Dravidian Family

Origin

- **Indigenous** to India — minimal outside influence (unlike Indo-Aryan)
- 21 Dravidian languages → 3 subgroups

Northern Dravidian (3 languages)

Language	Region
Brahui	Balochistan
Malto	Tribal areas of Bengal & Odisha
Kuru	Bengal, Odisha, Bihar, MP

Central Dravidian (11 languages)

- **Gondi, Khond, Kui, Manda, Gadaba, Gadwa, Kolami, Pengo, Naiki, Kuvi** — mostly tribal, small pockets
- **Telugu** — exception; widely spoken, non-tribal

Southern Dravidian (7 languages)

- **Kannada, Tamil, Malayalam, Tulu, Kodagu, Toda, Kota**

Four Major Dravidian Languages

Language	Speakers	Key Facts
Tamil	66M+ (21st C)	Oldest Dravidian language; developed alongside Sanskrit; Tolkappiyam (1st–4th C AD) = first known literature; spoken in India, N. Sri Lanka, Malaysia, Singapore, Mauritius, Fiji, Myanmar; Tamil words found in Rigveda — evidence of North-South cultural exchange
Malayalam	—	Originally a dialect of Tamil on SW coast; evolved into separate language; borrows from Sanskrit; Ramacharitham (12th C AD) = first known literary work
Kannada	—	Official language of Karnataka ; earliest inscriptions from 5th C AD ; earliest literature: Kaviraja Marga (9th C AD); Vijayanagara Empire (14th–15th C) = golden phase for Kannada & Telugu literature
Telugu	—	Largest population among Dravidian languages ; 3rd most spoken in India (after Hindi & Bengali); first known work: Nannaya Bhatta's poetic translation of Mahabharata (11th C AD); borrows words from Kannada (geographical proximity)

5. Sino-Tibetan Family

- ~0.6% of India's population
- Spoken along **North & Northeastern frontiers**
- Influenced by **China, Tibet, Myanmar** languages

Four Subgroups

Group	Languages
Tibetic	Sikmi, Bhutia, Balti, Sherpa, Lahuli, Ladakhi
Himalayan	Kinnauri, Limbu
North Assam	Abor, Miri, Aka, Dafla, Mishmi
Assam-Burmese	Kuki, Chin, Mikir, Bodo, Naga

6. Historical Evolution Timeline

Period	Development
Harappan (3500-1900 BC)	Writing remains found, script still undeciphered
Vedic Age (~1900 BC)	Sanskrit development begins
Gupta Period (4th-6th C AD)	Golden Age of Sanskrit literature
600-1000 AD	Prakrit flourishes; Pali for Buddhist texts
8th-9th C AD	Prakrit → Apabhramsha
Post-1000 AD	Modern Indo-Aryan languages emerge (Hindi, Bengali, etc.)
10th-14th C	Transitional phase — all major modern Indian languages develop
Post-18th C	British rule → Nationalist literature; social reform & freedom struggle themes; printing press amplifies reach
Post-1947	Spread of education & literacy; literature reaches all sections of society

7. Constitutional Provisions — Official Languages

Article 343(1)

- **Official language of the Union:** Hindi in **Devanagari script**
- **English** permitted for all official purposes for **15 years** (until **26 Jan 1965**)

Official Languages Act, 1963

- **English granted status of "subsidiary official language"** (after protests from non-Hindi states)
- Union government work can be done in **both Hindi and English**

Eighth Schedule — Scheduled Languages

- Listed in **8th Schedule** of the Constitution
- **States free to choose their own official language**
- **Initially 14 languages** listed (transcript cuts off before full list; today there are **22**)
- Existence of **22 Scheduled Languages** + many non-scheduled languages with active literature

Key Debate (1947)

- North India wanted **Hindi as national language**; South India disagreed
- Tribals also had rich language histories
- **Constitution makers chose middle path** — no single "national language"; instead **Official Language + Subsidiary Official Language + Scheduled Languages**
- Language nationalism seen as divisive (example: Europe splitting into small countries along language lines)

Martial Arts of India

Language and physical discipline both shaped Indian culture. India's martial arts traditions, from Kalari Payattu to Gatka, combine combat with spirituality and performance.

1. Kalari Payattu (Kerala)

- **Oldest martial art in the world**; originated in Kerala around 4th century CE
- Spread to Southeast Asia, Japan, China — influenced Jujitsu, Kung Fu, Taekwondo, Karate
- **Originator**: Guru Parshuram (as per scriptures)
- **Kalari** = Malayalam word for the special training ground (pit dug 4–5 ft, filled with soft soil)
- **4 Stages**:
- **Mai Payattu** — body conditioning, joint & muscle stretching
- **Kol Thari Payattu** — wooden weapons (long canes, short canes, Otta = animal-horn-shaped bent weapon)
- **Ankathar Payattu** — sharp weapons: sword & shield, spear, dagger, **Urumi** (flexible sword worn at waist like a belt, hidden, used in emergencies)

- **Verum Kai** — bare-handed defense against armed/unarmed opponents
- **Golden Age**: Practiced by kings in gurukuls; each had a squad of Kalari practitioners
- **Decline**: Banned by British in 1804 after the **Kerala Arm Revolt**; possession of weapons led to imprisonment
- **Post-Independence**: Revival efforts; now developed as a competitive sport
- **Today**: Not part of warfare but excellent for physical fitness & self-defense

2. Silambam (Tamil Region)

- Also one of the oldest martial art forms
- Geographical proximity to Kerala → practices similar to Kalari Payattu
- **Originator**: Sage Agastya (Rishi Agastya)
- **History**: Dates to at least 4th century BCE (per Sangam literature); used for self-defense & against wild animals
- **Chera, Chola, Pandya** dynasties developed organized warfare form; kings trained in gurukuls & maintained Silambam fighter squads
- 18th century: Successfully used against British but lost due to superior British arms, ammunition & naval power
- **Banned** after British occupation; revived post-Independence as martial art & sport
- **Main weapon: Bamboo stick** — flexible, does not break in combat
- **Variation: Torch Silambam** — burning cotton cloth tied to both ends of bamboo stick
- **Other weapons**: Aruva (sickle), Vaal (curved sword), Katti (knife)
- In sports form, mostly limited to bamboo stick

3. Paari Khanda (Bihar, Jharkhand, Odisha)

- **Paari** = sword; **Khanda** = shield
- Main weapons are **sword and shield**
- Practice is very similar to **Chhau dance**
- Chhau dance is believed to be **derived from Paari Khanda**

4. Thoda (Himachal Pradesh)

- Originated in Himachal Pradesh; mix of martial art, sport & culture
- Played during **Baisakhi (April)**

- Tests **archery skills** of players
- **Main equipment:** Bow & arrows (made of wood)
- **Inspiration:** Archery duels during Mahabharata times in Kullu & Manali valleys
- **Bow length:** 1.5m – 2m (proportional to player height)
- Equipment made by **traditional artisans**
- **Two teams:** Pashi and Sathi — considered descendants of **Pandavas** and **Kauravas**
- Up to **500 members per team**; some are dancers (not fighters) who boost morale
- Not just martial art — reflects **spirituality**, celebrated as a **festival**, promotes **community bonding**

5. Gatka (Punjab — Sikh)

- Performed by **Sikhs of Punjab**
- **Origin:** After 5th Guru **Guru Arjan Dev** was killed by Mughals in 1606; his son **Guru Hargobind** started it to defend the community
- **17th century:** **Guru Gobind Singh** (himself a weapons expert) developed & gave it final form
- Earlier used in combat & war; now practiced for **physical fitness & self-defense**
- Practiced **with and without weapons**
- **Main weapons:**
 - Soti — long wooden stick
 - Tega — long broad sword
 - Chakkar — round weapon with wooden balls at ends
- When played as a sport, movements performed to beats of **dhol & nagada**
- Performed in **large processions** on: Guru Nanak's birthday, Guru Gobind Singh Jayanti

6. Thang-Ta (Manipur)

- **Thang** = sword; **Ta** = spear → main weapons
- Used by Manipuri kings to fight
- **Banned** when Manipur came under British control; revived post-Independence
- **3 forms of practice today:**
 - **Ritualistic** — linked to Tantric practices
 - **Performance** — beautiful spear & sword dance
 - **Actual fighting**

7. Mardani Khel (Maharashtra)

- Traditional martial art of Maharashtra
- **Origin:** Maratha guerrilla warfare against Mughals
- Weapons & movements designed for **Western Ghat terrain** — fast movements, rapid attacks in tough mountain passes with minimal weapons
- **Weapons:** Lathi (stick), Sword, Shield (Dhal-Talwar), Khanda (double-edged straight sword), Dand-Patta (double-edged flexible sword)
- **Banned** by British; transformed into a **sport** — "Mardani Khel"
- **Unique feature:** Men and women trained together with same weapons, treated equally

8. Masti Yuddha (Varanasi / Banaras)

- Popular in **Varanasi** and surrounding areas
- Very old origin; mentioned in the **Ramayana**
- **Masti Yuddha** = from two Sanskrit words

Quick Reference Table

Martial Art	State/Region	Key Weapons	Key Feature
Kalari Payattu	Kerala	Urumi, sword, shield, spear, dagger, otta	World's oldest martial art; 4 training stages
Silambam	Tamil Nadu	Bamboo stick, aruva, vaal, katti	Dates to 4th century BCE; torch variation
Paari Khanda	Bihar, Jharkhand, Odisha	Sword (Paari), Shield (Khanda)	Chhau dance derived from it
Thoda	Himachal Pradesh	Bow & arrows	Baisakhi festival; Pandavas vs Kauravas teams
Gatka	Punjab	Soti, Tega, Chakkar	Sikh martial art; Guru Hargobind & Guru Gobind Singh
Thang-Ta	Manipur	Sword (Thang), Spear (Ta)	3 forms: ritualistic, dance, actual fighting
Mardani Khel	Maharashtra	Lathi, Khanda, Dand-Patta, Dhal-Talwar	Men & women trained equally; Western Ghat terrain
Masti Yuddha	Varanasi	—	Mentioned in Ramayana

Fairs & Festivals of India

India's cultural calendar is punctuated by an extraordinary number of fairs and festivals, celebrating every faith, season, and harvest through shared joy.

Key General Notes

- Festival dates mostly based on **Lunar calendar** → dates vary yearly
- **Solar calendar** exceptions: Makar Sankranti, National Festivals → fixed dates
- India: vast diversity of religions, languages, customs, traditions; likely no day without a festival somewhere

1. Makar Sankranti

Aspect	Detail
When	14 January (fixed – solar calendar)
Deity	Sun God
Significance	End of winter, start of summer; days lengthen in Northern Hemisphere (Uttarayan / northward movement of sun)
Regional names	Punjab: Maghi (+ Lohri day before), Tamil Nadu: Pongal , West Bengal: Poush Parbon , Gujarat: Uttarayan

2. Eid-ul-Fitr

Aspect	Detail
Faith	Islam
Timing	End of Ramadan (9th month of Islamic calendar) → beginning of Shawwal (10th month)
Ramadan significance	Month of fasting (Roza); Quran revealed to Prophet Muhammad; Battle of Badr victory; martyrdom of Abu Talib
Crescent moon	Eid celebrated when crescent moon is sighted
Observance	Month: fasting, contemplation, prayers. Eid day: joy, celebration

3. Muharram

Aspect	Detail
Faith	Islam
Timing	1st month of Islamic calendar
10th day	Yaum al-Ashura
Event	Martyrdom of Prophet Muhammad's grandson Husain bin Ali at Battle of Karbala
Observance	Mourning; Shia Muslims take out Tazia processions , youth beat themselves with whips to remember Husain Ali's sufferings

4. Easter & Good Friday

Aspect	Detail
Faith	Christianity
Good Friday	Crucifixion of Jesus Christ
Easter	Resurrection of Jesus Christ
Observance	Masses in churches; traditional Easter eggs , cakes, bakery products

5. Gurupurab

Aspect	Detail
Faith	Sikhism
When	Birth anniversaries of all 10 Sikh Gurus
Most important	Guru Nanak Jayanti & Guru Govind Singh Jayanti
Also observed	Martyrdom of Guru Arjun Dev & Guru Tegh Bahadur
Celebrations	Special services & Langar at Gurudwaras; Akhand Path (continuous reading of Guru Granth Sahib); Prabhat Pheris (morning processions singing hymns); final procession of Guru Granth Sahib in flower-decorated palanquin led by Panj Pyare carrying Nishan Sahib
Reach	Celebrated across India; special significance in Punjab

6. Mahavir Jayanti

Aspect	Detail
Faith	Jainism
Event	Birth anniversary of 24th Tirthankara Lord Mahavira
Month	Bhadrapad
Rituals	Temples decorated with saffron flags ; abhishek (milk bath) of idol; idol carried in procession
Major regions	Gujarat & Rajasthan (large Jain populations)

7. Buddha Purnima (Buddha Jayanti)

Aspect	Detail
Faith	Buddhism
Event	Birth anniversary of Lord Buddha
When	April/May (full moon)
Regions	North East India & Northern India
Key sites	Bodh Gaya, Sarnath, Rajgir
Observance	Special pujas, ritualistic prayers, sermons of Buddhist gurus, chanting of scriptures, worship of Buddha images, meditation

8. Jamshedji Navroze (Parsi New Year)

Aspect	Detail
Faith	Zoroastrianism (founded by Prophet Zarathustra)
Event	Parsi New Year
Global date	March 21 – sun shines directly on equator, summer begins
Indian Parsis	Follow Shahenshahi calendar → dates vary
History	Persecuted in Persia (Iran) after Islam arrived → migrated to India; India now has largest Parsi community
~3000 year old tradition	
Observance	Pray for health & prosperity; visit Fire Temples ; visit homes; evening feast

9. Festivals of North East India

9a. Losar Festival

Aspect	Detail
Faith	Mahayana Buddhism (Tibetan Buddhists)
Regions	Arunachal Pradesh, Himachal Pradesh, Ladakh
Significance	Tibetan New Year
Duration	3 days , starting 11 February
Day 1	Lama Losar – worship of Dalai Lama ; procession in his honor
Decorations	Monasteries with colorful prayer flags
Cham Dance	Mask dance – performers in colorful costumes & elaborate masks; depicts death of cruel King Langdarma ; symbolizes victory of good over evil
Tourism	Large number of foreign tourists visit for Losar

9b. Bihu (Bohag Bihu)

Aspect	Detail
State	Assam
Significance	Assamese New Year ; linked to changing seasons & agricultural harvest
Frequency	3 Bihus in a year; Bohag Bihu (April) is most important
When	14 April
Tribes	Various Assamese tribes celebrate for 1 week to 1 month
Traditions	Pitha (traditional dish); Bihu dance performed

9c. Hornbill Festival

Aspect	Detail
State	Nagaland
Type	Major agricultural festival
Duration	Week-long , starts 1 December
Venue	Kisama Heritage Village – all Naga tribes gather
Activities	Fairs, traditional dances

9d. Majuli Festival

Aspect	Detail
State	Assam
Venue	Majuli – world's largest river island (in Brahmaputra River)
When	November
Purpose	Showcase Assamese cultural heritage, traditional history
Activities	Tribes from Assam & other NE states display traditional arts & crafts ; traditional dance & music

9e. Ambubachi Mela

Aspect	Detail
State	Assam
Venue	Kamakhya Temple , Guwahati
Deity	Goddess Kamakhya – Fertility Goddess
When	June
Significance	Large congregation; called " Maha Kumbh of North East "
Notable	Childless couples come for darshan in large numbers
Controversy	Known for Tantric practices performed during the mela (sometimes controversial)

UNESCO World Heritage Sites in India

Fairs preserve living culture; monuments preserve built heritage. India's 40 UNESCO World Heritage Sites represent the pinnacle of its cultural and natural legacy.

UNESCO — Background

- **UNESCO**: United Nations Educational, Scientific and Cultural Organization
- **Established**: 1945 — post-WWII (to promote peace, cultural exchange, dialogue)
- **Objective**: World peace via international cooperation in education, science, culture
- **Trigger event**: 1960 — Abu Simbel Temple (Egypt) threatened by dam; UNESCO launched international rescue mission → global awareness of endangered heritage
- **1972**: UNESCO World Heritage Convention formed
- **World Heritage Committee**: 21 members; selects & categorises sites

Three Categories

Category	Description
Cultural	Human civilisation significance
Natural	Nature preservation significance
Mixed	Both cultural & natural significance

Benefits of UNESCO Tag

- Global attention on site
- Easier government & NGO funding for preservation
- Protected under Geneva Convention & Hague Convention for Protection of Cultural Sites (even during war/armed conflict)

India Statistics (as of 2022)

- **Total**: 40 sites
- **32** Cultural
- **7** Natural
- **1** Mixed

CULTURAL SITES

1. Ajanta & Ellora Caves

	Ajanta	Ellora
Location	Aurangabad, Maharashtra	Aurangabad, Maharashtra
Year	1983	1983
No. of caves	29	34
Religion	Buddhist only (25 viharas, 4 chaityas)	17 Hindu + 12 Buddhist + 5 Jain
Period	200 BCE – 650 CE	5th – 11th century CE
Dynasty	Satavahana & Vakataka	Worker groups from Vidarbha, Karnataka, Tamil Nadu
Key feature	Fresco wall paintings (Buddha's life & Jataka tales)	Kailashnath Temple (Cave 16) — rock-cut top-to-bottom
Other	Described by Chinese travellers Fa-Hien & Hiuen Tsang	Architectural styles & subjects vary widely

2. Taj Mahal

- **Year:** 1983 | **State:** Uttar Pradesh
- **Builder:** Shah Jahan (1632 – 1648)
- **Style:** Islamic + Indian + Persian + Turkish architecture; emphasis on symmetry
- **Material:** White Makrana marble → changes colour: pink (morning), milky white (afternoon), reddish (sunset), charming (full moon)
- **Setting:** Rectangular garden, Yamuna River beside, 4 minarets around main tomb
- **Significance:** One of the 7 Wonders of the Modern World

3. Sun Temple, Konark

- **Year:** 1984 | **State:** Odisha (35 km NE of Puri, on coastline)
- **Builder:** King Narasimha Deva I (Eastern Ganga Dynasty), ~1250 AD

- **Structure:** 100-ft high chariot of Sun God, facing east (first rays hit principal entrance)
- **Navigation:** Served as navigation point for sailors; called **Black Pagoda** by European sailors
- **Sculptures:** Hindu mythology & culture themes

4. Group of Monuments at Mahabalipuram (Mamallapuram)

- **Year:** 1984 | **State:** Tamil Nadu (Coromandel Coast)
- **Dynasty:** Pallava (7th – 8th century AD)
- **Context:** Important seaport of Pallavas; 2nd most important city after Kanchipuram; prosperous trading hub
- **Four monument types:**
- **Ratha Temples** — rock-cut chariot-shaped temples; 5 popular ones named after Pandavas (Dharmaraja Rath, Bhima Rath, Arjuna Rath, Nakula-Sahadeva Rath, Draupadi Rath)
- **Mandapas** — cave temples (cut into hill faces like Ajanta/Ellora)
- **Rock Reliefs** — e.g. **Descent of Ganga (Arjuna's Penance)**
- **Structural Temples** — e.g. **Shore Temple** (earliest structural temple in Indian subcontinent)
- **Significance:** Early example of Dravidian style of temple architecture

5. Khajuraho Group of Monuments

- **Year:** 1986 | **State:** Madhya Pradesh (Chhatarpur district)
- **Dynasty:** Chandela (950 – 1050 AD)
- **Originally:** 85 temples → only 20 survived (due to time, plundering, destruction)
- **Religion:** Hinduism & Jainism
- **Style:** Nagara style of temple architecture (North India)
- **Key temples:** Kandariya Mahadev Temple, Lakshmana Temple
- **Sculptures:** Intricately carved; religious themes + common life (women applying makeup, potters, musicians, farmers) + erotic sculptures (theme from Vatsyayana's Kamasutra)

6. Fatehpur Sikri

- **Year:** 1986 | **State:** Uttar Pradesh (36 km from Agra)
- **Builder:** Mughal Emperor Akbar (capital shifted from Agra, 1572 – 1585)

- **Story:** Akbar prayed for a son; Sufi saint Salim Chishti (at Sikri) blessed him → son born → Akbar shifted capital to honour the saint
- **Name:** Fatehpur Sikri = "City of Victory" (after Akbar's Gujarat victory, 1573)
- **Key monuments:**
- **Buland Darwaza** (54 m, southern entrance, built to celebrate Gujarat victory)
- **Panch Mahal** (4-storey; Akbar & queens listened to Tansen's music)
- **Jodhabai Palace**
- **Salim Chishti's Tomb** (white marble, intricate jali work; inside Jama Masjid complex)
- **Jama Masjid** (red sandstone)
- **Ibadat Khana** (Akbar held interfaith discussions)
- **Note:** Entire complex built in red sandstone; only Salim Chishti's Tomb is in white marble

7. Group of Monuments at Hampi

- **Year:** 1986 | **State:** Karnataka (Tungabhadra River, south coast)
- **Empire:** Vijayanagara Empire (capital city)
- **Historical accounts:** Persian traveller **Abdul Razzaq** — Hampi was 2nd largest city in medieval world (after Beijing); wealthy, grand city with temples, farms, trading markets
- **Destruction:** 1565 Battle of Talikota → Deccan Sultanates plundered for 6 months → city abandoned
- **Rediscovered:** Colin Mackenzie (1800)
- **Key monuments:**
- **Virupaksha Temple** (dedicated to Shiva as guardian deity of Vijayanagara; pre-dates empire but enlarged & decorated by Vijayanagara kings)
- **Vittala Temple** (dedicated to Vitthala, form of Vishnu) — **Stone Chariot** (brand symbol of Hampi)
- **Lotus Mahal** (Indo-Islamic architecture; built for queen & royal ladies)
- **Architecture:** Grandeur of ruins reflects city's wealth & culture (temples, mosques, civil & military buildings)

8. Hill Forts of Rajasthan

- **Year:** 2013
- **6 forts inscribed collectively:**
- **Chittorgarh Fort** (Chittorgarh)

- **Kumbhalgarh Fort** (Kumbhalgarh)
- **Ranthambore Fort** (Sawai Madhopur)
- **Jaisalmer Fort** (Jaisalmer)
- **Amber Fort** (Jaipur)
- **Gagron Fort** (Jhalawar)
- **Period:** 8th – 18th century, built by Rajput kings
- **Strategy:** Built using natural defences — deserts, rivers, hills, dense forests

9. Great Living Chola Temples

- **Year:** 1987
- **Dynasty:** Chola (11th – 12th century AD; peak — extent from Sri Lanka to Krishna-Godavari basin)
- **Three temples** (represent grandeur of Dravidian architecture):

Temple	Location	Builder	Year	Dedicated to
Brihadeeswarar Temple	Thanjavur	Raja Raja Chola I	1003–1010 AD	Lord Shiva
Brihadeeswarar Temple	Gangaikonda Cholapuram	Rajendra I	1035 AD	Lord Shiva
Airavatesvara Temple	Darasuram	Raja Raja II	1150 AD	Lord Shiva

- **Highlights:**
- Thanjavur Brihadeeswarar: Made of granite; tallest vimana in South India; one of India's largest Shivalings; massive corridors; sculptures represent Shaivism, Vaishnavism, Shakti traditions
- Gangaikonda Cholapuram: Built by Rajendra I after defeating Pala kings of the North; ~80 km from ancient Chola capital
- Airavatesvara: Last great Chola temple

10. Red Fort (Lal Qila)

- **Year:** 2007 | **State:** Delhi (Shahjahanabad / Old Delhi)
- **Builder:** Shah Jahan (after shifting capital from Agra to Delhi)

- **Significance:** Centre of Mughal empire; last Mughal ruler Bahadur Shah Zafar lived here until 1857 Revolt; PM hoists tricolor every 15 August (Independence Day)
- **Key structures:**
- **Diwan-e-Aam** (Hall of Public Audience — emperor met common people)
- **Diwan-e-Khas** (Hall of Private Audience — met ministers, housed the **Peacock Throne** with Kohinoor diamond; stolen by Nadir Shah in 1739 to Persia)

NATURAL SITES

1. Sundarbans National Park

- **Year:** 1987 | **State:** West Bengal (Ganga Delta)
- **Key feature:** Largest mangrove forest; Tiger Reserve & Biosphere Reserve; one of India's largest reserves
- **Species:** Endangered Royal Bengal Tiger, Ganges Dolphin, Spotted Deer, Wild Boar, Saltwater Crocodiles, other mammals & amphibians
- **Habitat:** Dense mangrove forest cover

2. Great Himalayan National Park

- **Year:** 2014 | **State:** Himachal Pradesh (Kullu region)
- **Established:** 1984 | **Area:** 1000+ sq km
- **Altitude:** 1500 – 6000 m → diverse flora & ~375 fauna species

3. Keoladeo National Park (Bharatpur)

- **Year:** 1985 (National Park: 1982) | **State:** Rajasthan (Bharatpur district)
- **Former name:** Bharatpur Wildlife Sanctuary
- **Named after:** Keoladeo (Shiva) Temple inside the park
- **Ramsar Site** (wetlands of ecological importance threatened by human activity)
- **Threat:** Dam built upstream on Gambhir River → reduced freshwater flow; govt now releases additional water
- **Avifauna sanctuary:** Thousands of rare & endangered migratory birds (cranes, pelicans, hawks, geese, ducks)
- **Animals:** Golden Jackal, Striped Hyena, Jungle Cat, Nilgai, Blackbuck, Fishing Cat, Wild Boar

4. Western Ghats

- **Year:** Inscribed as serial property
- **Spread:** Gujarat → Tamil Nadu (7000+ sq km, 6 states: Gujarat, Maharashtra, Goa, Karnataka, Kerala, Tamil Nadu)
- **Geology:** Older than Himalayas
- **Biodiversity:** One of the world's **8 hottest biodiversity hotspots**; ~325 globally threatened species (flora, fauna, birds, amphibians, reptiles, fish)
- **Climate role:** Regulates India's monsoon climate
- **Threats:** Construction, mining, agriculture; deforestation linked to unprecedented floods (e.g. Kerala)

Schools of Philosophy

Beyond material heritage, India's intellectual heritage is equally profound. Its schools of philosophy have shaped the subcontinent's spiritual landscape for millennia.

1. Introduction: Philosophy in India

- **Darshan Shastra** = Indian term for philosophy (darshan = perspective/way of seeing)
- Philosophical questions addressed: Who created the universe? Is there another world? What is dharma/adharma?
- **Two major traditions** based on Veda acceptance:

Tradition	Belief	Schools
Orthodox (Astika)	Accept Veda authority; Veda are infallible/supreme	Sankhya, Nyaya, Vaisheshika, Yoga, Purva Mimamsa, Vedanta (Uttara Mimamsa)
Heterodox (Nastika)	Reject Veda authority	Jainism, Buddhism, Ajivika, Charvaka

2. Common Principles Across All Six Orthodox Schools

1. **Dharma ≠ Religion** — Dharma = Code of Conduct (universal, applies to both theist & atheist)

2. **Dharma gives life meaning** — separates humans from animals (who are controlled by sense organs). Through dharma, one achieves **Purusharthas**:
3. **Dharma → Artha → Kama → Moksha** (merging with Paramatma)
4. **Logic, reasoning & analysis** used to address metaphysical/spiritual issues — not blind faith

3. The Six Orthodox Schools

3.1 Sankhya School

Aspect	Detail
Founder	Kapila Muni
Text	Sankhya Sutra
Core Philosophy	Dualism (Dvaitavada) — universe divided into Purusha & Prakriti
Purusha	Consciousness/Chaitanya; Soul (Atma) & Mind; Intangible (cannot be touched/seen, only felt)
Prakriti	Tangible — can be seen/felt via sense organs; includes all living & non-living things
Jiva (life) birth	When Purusha attaches to Prakriti through Desires (Kamana/Ichha)
Maya	These desires fulfilled via sense organs (eye, ear, nose, skin, tongue)
Death & Moksha	Purusha separates from Prakriti → merges into Cosmic Consciousness . This state = Moksha/Salvation
Key Points	× Denies existence of God/Superhuman. × Silent on reincarnation. □ Right knowledge → Moksha

3.2 Nyaya School

Aspect	Detail
Founder	Akshapada Gautama
Text	Nyaya Sutra
Core Philosophy	Logic, Reasoning & Analysis — most rational school of Hindu philosophy
Four Pillars of Valid Knowledge	1. Perception (Anubhuti) 2. Inference (Anuman) 3. Comparison (Tulana) 4. Testimony (Sakshya)
Comparison	Similar to Socrates & Plato (Ancient Greece)
God	☐ Believes in God — God created, sustains, and destroys the universe
Path to Moksha	Use logical thinking

3.3 Vaisheshika School

Aspect	Detail
Founder	Rishi Kanada
Core Philosophy	Realistic & Objective — universe made of Atoms (Anu)
God/Brahman	Fundamental force that gives consciousness to atoms
Atomic theory	Atoms → Molecules → Elements
Five Elements (Pancha Mahabhuta)	Prithvi (Earth) — Vayu (Air) — Jal (Water) — Agni (Fire) — Akash (Ether/Space)
Significance	Major role in early Physics (Bhautik Vigyan) in Indian subcontinent
Relation to Nyaya	Closely associated; later merged with Nyaya (both believed in scientific reasoning)
God	☐ Believes in God/Cosmic Power as sutradhar (controller)

3.4 Yoga School

Aspect	Detail
Founder	Rishi Patanjali
Text	Yoga Sutra (~2nd century BC) — considered origin of Yoga
Core Idea	Combination of Physical, Mental & Spiritual practice + Discipline
Goal	Meditation & Yogic techniques → separate Purusha from Prakriti → attain Moksha/Salvation
Eight Limbs (Ashtanga)	1. Yama (self-control) 2. Niyama (observance of rules) 3. Asana (fixed postures) 4. Pranayama (breath control) 5. Pratyahara (choosing an object/withdrawal) 6. Dharana (fixing the mind) 7. Dhyana (concentrating/meditation) 8. Samadhi (complete dissolution of self, mind & object merge)
Later Influence	Became part of Buddhism & Jainism too
UN Recognition	International Yoga Day — June 21 (annually)

3.5 Purva Mimamsa School

Aspect	Detail
Founder	Rishi Jaimini
Literal Meaning	Mimamsa = Reasoning, Interpretation & Application
Focus	Ritualistic part of Vedas — Samhita & Brahmana portions
Core Belief	Vedas contain Eternal Truth ; Moksha/Swarga requires fulfilling all duties prescribed in Vedas
Emphasis	Not just performing rituals, but also understanding the justification & reasoning behind them
Social Impact	Encouraged Priestly class (Brahmins) → created social distance between Brahmins & common people
Problem	Only priestly class could read/interpret Vedas; common people were uneducated & lacked access → dependent on priests for every ritual

3.6 Uttara Mimamsa / Vedanta School

Aspect	Detail
Nature	Most important & philosophically advanced Orthodox school; precursor to Bhakti Movement (Medieval age)
Key Difference from Purva Mimamsa	Purva Mimamsa focuses on Samhita & Brahmana (early Veda parts); Vedanta focuses on Upanishads (end of Vedas)
Four Parts of Vedas	1. Brahmana 2. Samhita 3. Aranyaka 4. Upanishad (last = Vedanta = end of Veda)
Oldest Text	Brahma Sutra (2nd century AD)
Core Philosophy	Brahma/God = Ultimate Truth ; everything else = Maya (illusion)
Three Basic Hindu Texts	1. Upanishads 2. Brahma Sutras 3. Bhagavad Gita
Later Development	Many sub-schools of Vedanta developed from 8th century AD onward

4. Summary Table: Orthodox Schools at a Glance

School	Founder	Text	God?	Core Idea
Sankhya	Kapila Muni	Sankhya Sutra	× No	Dualism: Purusha + Prakriti; desires = Maya; knowledge → Moksha
Nyaya	Akshapada Gautama	Nyaya Sutra	☐ Yes	Logic & Reasoning; 4 pillars: perception, inference, comparison, testimony
Vaisheshika	Rishi Kanada	—	☐ Yes	Atomic theory; 5 elements; objective realism; merged with Nyaya
Yoga	Rishi Patanjali	Yoga Sutra (~200 BC)	—	8 limbs (Ashtanga); meditation & discipline → separate Purusha from Prakriti
Purva Mimamsa	Rishi Jaimini	—	—	Focus on Vedic rituals/duties; priestly dominance; eternal truth in Vedas
Vedanta	—	Brahma Sutra (2nd c. AD)	☐ Yes	Upanishads focus; Brahma = ultimate truth; world = Maya; basis of Bhakti movement

5. Key Terms

Term	Meaning
Darshan	Perspective / way of seeing
Dharma	Code of conduct (not religion)
Purushartha	Four aims: Dharma → Artha → Kama → Moksha
Purusha	Consciousness/soul (intangible)
Prakriti	Nature/matter (tangible)
Maya	Illusion; desires fulfilled through senses
Moksha	Salvation; merging Purusha with Cosmic Consciousness
Atma	Soul
Paramatma / Brahman	Supreme soul / God
Anu	Atom
Samadhi	Complete dissolution of self
Upnishad	End portion of Vedas = Vedanta

Bhakti & Sufi Movement

Philosophical schools found practical expression in the Bhakti and Sufi movements, which brought devotional spirituality to the masses and fostered India's composite culture.

I. FOUNDATIONAL PHILOSOPHERS (Pre-Bhakti)

Philosopher	Century	Philosophy	Core Belief
Adi Shankaracharya	~8th C	Advaita Vedanta (Non-Dualism)	Atma & Parmatma are one. Established 4 Maths: Badrinath, Shringeri, Jagannath Puri, Dwarka.
Ramanuja	12th C	Vishishtadvaita (Qualified Monism)	Atma cannot fully merge with Parmatma; only those with true knowledge can unite.
Madhavacharya	13th C	Dvaita (Dualism)	Atma & Parmatma are separate entities. Salvation through devotion to God.

Swami Vivekananda later propagated Advaita Vedanta in the West.

II. BHAKTI MOVEMENT — INTRODUCTION

- **Period:** 6th–12th Century AD, started in **Tamil Nadu** (South India)
- **Pre-Bhakti Hinduism:** dominated by Brahminical rituals, sacrifices (yajnas), Sanskrit exclusivity — inaccessible to common people
- **Bhakti alternative:** Personal devotion (bhakti) to God → sufficient for salvation; elaborate rituals unnecessary
- **Tools:** Bhajans, kirtans, poetry in local/common languages
- **Stance on Caste:** Opposed caste system; open to all (especially lower castes)
- **Key Groups:**
 - **Nayanars** → devotees of **Shiva**
 - **Alvars** → devotees of **Vishnu**

Spread to North India → Two Streams

Stream	God	Key Saints
Nirguna	Formless (Nirakar)	Kabir, Guru Nanak
Saguna	With form (Sakar)	Tulsidas, Surdas, Meera, Chaitanya Mahaprabhu

Saguna further split into: - **Vaishnav** (Vishnu / Ram / Krishna) - **Shaiv** (Shiva) - **Shakta** (Devi / Shakti — popular in East & North-East India)

III. NIRGUNA SAINTS

Kabir

- One of the most important Nirguna saints
- **Background:** Abandoned by Brahmin widow mother; raised by poor Muslim weaver family
- **Beliefs:**
 - Formless God — rejected **idol worship, yajnas/havans** (Hindu), **namaz** (Muslim)
 - All religions refer to the same one God (Ram, Hari, Govind, Allah, Rahim, Khuda)
 - Only path: **personal devotion**; external religious aspects irrelevant
 - **Social critique:** Challenged narrow-minded societal norms through forceful, direct poetry
- **Legacy:**
 - His dohas (couplets) reflect unity of God
 - After death, Hindus & Muslims both claimed his body
 - Ideas incorporated into **Adi Granth Sahib** (Sikh holy book)
 - Followers formed **Kabir Panthi** sect

Guru Nanak (1469-1539)

- Nirguna / Nirakar God worshipper
- Not intended to create a new religion; followers later formed **Sikhism**
- **Born:** Talwandi (Nankana Sahib, now Pakistan)
- **Personality:** Simplicity + Peacefulness; helped poor & needy
- **Objective:** Remove corrupt & degrading practices from society
- **Social Reforms:**
 - Advocated **social equality** (against caste divisions)
 - Advocated for **women's condition**
- **Legacy:** Teachings compiled in **Guru Granth Sahib** (Sikh holy book)

IV. SAGUNA SAINTS

Surdas

- **Disciple of:** Vallabhacharya
- **Work:** Wrote **Sur Sagar** — recollections of Krishna's childhood & youth with deep affection
- Blind, yet composed vivid devotional poetry

Meera Bai

- Widowed at young age; considered **Shri Krishna as her husband**
- Wrote numerous devotional poems; still sung in Vrindavan

Chaitanya Mahaprabhu (1486-1534) — Eastern India

- **Vaishnavite:** Krishna = highest form of God (not just Vishnu's incarnation)
- **Sankirtan:** congregational chanting in temples, homes, streets
- **Hare Rama Hare Krishna** movement; core founder of **ISKCON** (International Society for Krishna Consciousness, est. New York 1966)

Ramanand (1400-1470)

- Popularized **Ram worship** in North India
- Women & outcasts allowed in his gatherings
- **Kabir is considered his disciple**

Tulsidas (1523-1623)

- Wrote **Ramcharitmanas** (epic poem on Ram's life)
- Foremost Ram-bhakta

V. IMPORTANCE OF BHATKI MOVEMENT

Aspect	Impact
Reform	Reformed Hinduism from within; pushed stagnant society forward
Ritual opposition	Replaced elaborate rituals with personal devotion
Caste	Opposed caste divisions; first time lower castes produced religious leaders & followers
Language	Broke Sanskrit hegemony; brought religion to people in common languages
Philosophy	Broadly humanistic — love & equality for all beings
Social reform	Saints spoke against social evils

VI. SUFI MOVEMENT

- **Context:** Islamic orthodoxy (Ulemas) and rising materialism in Sultanate period
- **Response:** Liberal tradition within Islam → **Sufism**
- **Core message:** Simple life, devotion to God, **Ganga-Jamuni Tehzeeb** (composite culture), **Hindu-Muslim unity**

Etymology of "Sufi"

- **Suf** (wool) → coarse woolen clothes worn by Sufis
- OR **Safa** (purity) → reflects purity of Sufi saints

Timeline

- By **11th century**: well-developed movement with its own literature & practices

Organization

Term	Meaning
Khanqah	Place where Sufi teacher & disciples lived
Sheikh / Pir / Murshid	Sufi teacher
Murid	Disciple
Silsila	Chain / unbroken lineage of spiritual succession

Types of Silsilas (per Abul Fazl's Ain-e-Akbari — 14 total)

Type	Sharia?	Followed Namaz & Roza?	Examples
Ba-shara	Yes — bound by Islamic law	Yes	Chishti, Suhrawardi , Firdausi, Qadri, Naqshbandi
Be-shara	No — not bound by Sharia	No	Kalandar

VII. MAJOR SILSILAS IN INDIA

A) Chishti Silsila

Figure	Period	Key Details
Khwaja Moinuddin Chishti	~1192-1236	Founder in India; based in Ajmer, Rajasthan ; "Service to mankind = best devotion"; worked among poor; Akbar visited barefoot; millions still visit dargah today
Qutbuddin Bakhtiyar Kaki	d. 1235	Chief disciple; Qutub Minar (Delhi) built by Sultan Iltutmish in his memory
Baba Farid (Sheikh Fariduddin Ganj-e-Shakar)	1175-1265	Preached in Haryana & Punjab; open to all; preached in Punjabi ; teachings included in Adi Granth Sahib
Sheikh Nizamuddin Auliya	1238-1325	Most famous disciple of Baba Farid; made Delhi a major Chishti centre; saw 7 Sultans, never visited any court; believed worship incomplete without humanity service; loved qawwali (music helps feel God); Orthodox Ulemas disliked his liberal views
Sheikh Nasiruddin Mahmud (Chiragh-e-Delhi / Lamp of Delhi)	d. 1356	Last great Chishti saint of Delhi; after his death, Chishti Silsila shifted to Eastern & Southern India

B) Suhrawardi Silsila

Figure	Period	Key Details
Sheikh Shahabuddin Suhrawardi	—	Founder
Sheikh Bahauddin Zakariya	1182-1262	Established in India; maintained close ties with rulers ; accepted gifts & jagirs (unlike Chishti saints who kept distance from rulers)

VIII. QUICK COMPARISON — Chishti vs Suhrawardi

Aspect	Chishti	Suhrawardi
Relation with rulers	Kept distance	Close ties, accepted jagirs
Focus	Service to poor	More institutional
Music	Qawwali encouraged	—

IX. KEY TERMS GLOSSARY

Term	Meaning
Advaita	Non-dualism
Vishishtadvaita	Qualified monism
Dvaita	Dualism
Nirguna	God without form/attributes
Saguna	God with form/attributes
Nayanar	Shaivite saint
Alwar	Vaishnavite saint
Khanqah	Sufi hospice / monastery
Silsila	Chain of spiritual succession
Ba-shara	Sharia-following Sufi order
Be-shara	Non-Sharia Sufi order
Sankirtan	Congregational devotional singing
ISKCON	International Society for Krishna Consciousness (1966, NYC)
Ganga-Jamuni Tehzeeb	Composite Indo-Muslim culture
Ulema	Orthodox Muslim scholars

Spread of Indian Culture Abroad

Finally, we consider how Indian culture spread far beyond the subcontinent, influencing Central Asia, East Asia, Southeast Asia, and the Arab world through trade, scholarship, and spiritual exchange.

Core Idea

- India has been in contact with the outside world since the 3rd millennium BC (Harappan–Mesopotamian trade)
- Despite natural barriers (Himalayas in north, oceans on 3 sides), cultural exchange flourished
- Indian cultural influence visible today in South Asia, SE Asia, China, Japan, Korea, Central Asia
- Buddhism originated in India and spread to these regions
- Indian influence also seen in food, clothing, dance, festivals, daily life
- Unlike forced conversions elsewhere (Crusades, holy wars), Indian culture spread through **spiritualism, tolerance, and respect** for all cultures
- Adopting cultures **modified** Indian traditions per local geographic/historic conditions (e.g., Buddhism adapted locally in Tibet, China, Japan)

Means of Spread of Indian Culture

Factor	Role
Traders	Travelled long distances; west to Rome, east to China; in 1st C BC went to Cambodia, Java, Sumatra, Malay Islands (called Suvarna Dvipa - "Islands of Gold")
Scholars / Universities	Nalanda (east) & Vallabhi (west) were major cultural interaction centers; Xuan Zang described Nalanda as 7-story with 1500 teachers & ~10,000 students
Monks / Missionaries	Spread Buddhism to Tibet, China, Bhutan via Vikramashila & Dantapuri universities
Wanderers / Gypsies (Roma)	Travelled via land routes through Punjab → Sindh → Multan → Persia → Europe

Roma (Romani) People — Indian Origins

- Originated from **Northern Indian states**
- Legend: Alexander took them back after his Indian campaign
- Skilled weapon manufacturers & iron workers — high demand in armies
- Route: Sindh → Persia → Turkey → Europe
- Present in ~30 European countries; max population in **Turkey**
- **Romani language** shares numerals with Hindi: ek, duj, trin, štar, panč = एक, दो, तीन, चार, पाँच
- Cultural parallels with India: white = mourning, mehendi on hands, similar rituals/taboos
- One of the most persecuted tribes in Europe; many hide Indian roots due to discrimination

Region-Wise Spread

1. Central Asia

- **Present-day countries**: Turkmenistan, Tajikistan, Uzbekistan, Kazakhstan, Kyrgyzstan
- **Silk Road**: Started from Xi'an (China) → crisscrossed Central Asia → Europe; Indian traders accessed via Nepal-Tibet-Kashmir
- Carried goods + scholars + monks → spread Buddhism
- Remains of Buddhist stupas, monasteries, temples, statues found across Central Asia
- **Kingdom of Khotan** (present-day Chinese Xinjiang): 2000+ year old cultural link with India; coins had Chinese on front, **Prakrit** on back; monasteries had Sanskrit manuscripts

2. East Asia

China

- Contact from **2nd C BC**
- **Kashyapa Matanga** & **Dharmarakshita** (monk-scholars) invited by Han Emperor **Ming Ti** (67 AD) → introduced Buddhism; White Horse Monastery built for them
- Buddhism rapidly became popular → large number of Chinese Buddhist pilgrims came to India
- **Xuan Zang** (7th C AD): travelogues are key source for Harshavardhana's reign

- **Bodhidharma** (from Kanchipuram, studied at Nalanda): popularized Yoga & Meditation (Dhyana) in China; Meditation = "Chan" in Chinese, derived from Sanskrit **Dhyāna**
- **Wei Dynasty** (4th C AD): declared Buddhism **state religion**; thousands of Sanskrit texts translated to Chinese
- Chinese Buddhists built **rock-cut caves** similar to Ajanta & Ellora — e.g., **Dunhuang, Yungang, Longmen** caves; Yungang declared UNESCO World Heritage Site (1983)

Korea & Japan

- Buddhism spread from China → Korea → Japan
- Reached Japan ~525 AD via Korean emperor who sent Buddha statue, ritual objects, sacred texts with a friendship mission
- Journey: India → China → Korea → Japan took **at least 100 years**
- Conflict between native **Kami worshipers** (Shinto) & Buddhists; Buddhism prevailed due to **imperial sponsorship**
- Japan today: ~84 million Buddhist followers

Tibet

- Located on plateau north of Himalayas; mostly Buddhist today
- Buddhism became major religion by end of **8th C AD**
- Spread due to **Vikramashila & Nalanda** universities
- King **Thisong Detsen** invited two scholars from Nalanda:
- **Santarakshita**: built first Buddhist monastery in Tibet
- **Padmasambhava**: known for spiritual & magical powers; worshiped as Bodhisattva in Tibet

3. Sri Lanka

- Earliest contact evidence in **Ramayana** (demon king Ravana)
- Historically: **Mauryan king Ashoka** played key role — sent son **Mahendra** & daughter **Sanghamitra** to spread Buddhism
- Sri Lankan king **Devanampiya Tissa** converted → Buddhism became stronghold
- **Pali language** (popular in India) used in Sri Lanka; major Buddhist texts Dipavamsa & Mahavamsa written in Pali
- **Sinhalese language** = mixture of Pali + Tamil + Sanskrit
- Indian food, painting, dance, music also influenced Sri Lanka

4. Southeast Asia

Myanmar (Burma)

- Indian traders from Tamralipti & Amaravati ports travelled via land route to China
- Gradual Buddhist influence; King **Aniruddha** (10th C AD) united regions, promoted Buddhism
- Today ~80% population is Buddhist

Thailand

- Indian cultural influence from **1st C AD** onwards via traders, teachers, missionaries
- Buddhism wholeheartedly accepted
- Remains of **Vaishnava temples** found — evidence of Sanatana Dharma followers in the past

Cambodia

- Cultural & historical relations **2000+ years**
- Sanskrit name: **Kamboja**
- **Kaundinya dynasty** (Indian origin) ruled; Kaundinya prince from **Ganjam, Odisha** migrated & established first ruling dynasty
- Predominantly Buddhist today but retains **Hindu rituals, murti puja, Indian mythological aspects**
- **Khmer language** uses Sanskrit words extensively
- Hindu-Buddhist Indian temple architecture influenced construction
- **Angkor Wat**: originally dedicated to Lord Vishnu, later converted to Buddhist temple — living example of Indian cultural influence

Indonesia & Malaysia

- Ancient rulers adopted Indian culture (Indianized kingdoms)
- **Kedah province (Malaysia)**: Shiva statues excavated
- By medieval era, most population converted to **Islam** but retained Hindu roots
- **Deepavali & Dussehra** still celebrated in many parts
- **Indonesia**: Largest Shiva temple on Java island — **Prambanan**; nearby temples for Vishnu & Brahma, each with vahana shrines (Nandi, Garuda, Hamsa)
- Prambanan decorated with Ramayana & Mahabharata sculptures; built by **Sailendra Dynasty** (8th C AD); now **UNESCO World Heritage Site**

- **Bali island**: predominantly Hindu (80% residents) — statues of Shiva, Ganesha, Durga, Buddha found; Holi, Deepavali, Dussehra very popular; rest of Indonesia converted to Islam

5. Arab World

- Earliest trade links from **Harappan civilization**
- Two routes: Land & Sea; **Sea route cheaper/safer** due to monsoon winds
- Summer: monsoon blows toward India → traders came from Arabia to India
- Before winter: wind direction reverses → ships easily returned to Arabian Peninsula
- Monsoon winds were a **blessing** for India-Arab trade
- Arab world emerged as **transit hub** for India-Europe trade
- After Islam spread in West Asia, trade intensified
- **9th C AD onwards**: Travelers like **Sulaiman, Al-Masudi, Al-Idrisi** documented flourishing trade

Scientific & Cultural Exchange

- Indian scientific works first popular in Arab world → then reached Europe via Arabs
- **Astronomy**: Brahma-sphuta-siddhanta & Khandakhadyaka translated as Sindhind & Arkand; works of **Aryabhata** & **Varahamihira** translated to Arabic
- **Mathematics**: **Decimal number system** — biggest contribution; Europeans called it "Arabic numerals" but Arabs acknowledged Indian origins

6. Rome (Roman Empire)

- Contact very old; trade flourished during **Kushana rule** (1st C AD)
- High-demand Indian goods in Europe:
- Pepper, betel nut, spices, ivory, silk, muslin, precious stones
- Spices valued **higher than gold & silver**
- Pepper & ginger sold at **100x original Indian price**
- **Pliny** (Roman historian) documented this
- **Vasco da Gama's** 1498 discovery of direct sea route to India was driven by **spice trade** — Arabs acted as intermediaries, Europeans wanted to break Arab monopoly
- **Chola dynasty** ports: **Kaveripattinam** & **Mamallapuram** were major trading hubs to Europe
- Chola kings installed **lighthouses** at ports for ship guidance
- European merchants & ambassadors settled in South Indian towns

- Tamil kings recruited European bodyguards called **Yavanas**, especially for ship protection
- European sea adventuring ultimately culminated in **colonialism in India**

Final Message

- Indian culture teaches **tolerance**
- No other country has such diversity with people living peacefully
- Indian cultural diversity attracts tourists globally for fairs & festivals
- Need to **preserve** Indian cultural values and feel proud of them